NOTES FROM AN INVESTIGATOR

INTRODUCTION

Hello! This is m0nologue. I wrote this story, and you're reading the PDF version of it.

An explanation: Scott Cawthon once elaborated on The Freddy Files and confirmed that the original draft of the book was an investigative journalist attempting to piece together the mysteries of the series. We would be reading this investigator's notes, but the idea was scrapped.

This text is my personal interpretation of the following idea: *What if Scott Cawthon had kept this idea of The Freddy Files, and it conformed to FNAF's current lore?*

With this idea in mind, this story conforms to FNAF's lore as best it can, and I try to avoid veering off into blatant AU territory when possible. Much of this text and its plot points are made up by myself, but they are meant to supplement the canon of the FNAF games. My intention is to provide a piece of work that explains much of the series yet allows proper room for a mystery - great work was put into making this feel like an authentic piece of FNAF media.

That being said, the work is inherently a little biased as I'm only a fan. Keep the following ideas in mind as you read this. Under the narrative in this document:

- The Bite Victim does not become Golden Freddy or any other established character after the events of the FNAF 4 minigames. My view of the Bite Victim is a bit more symbolic than most.

- The Bite Victim is the first to die chronologically, followed by Charlie, and then Elizabeth shortly before the Missing Children Incident.

- All mainline FNAF games, the Fazbear Frights anthology series, and the Tales From the Pizzaplex series are considered to be in the same timeline. Thus, novel-exclusive characters and concepts such as Andrew, the Mimic, and Eleanor are canon to this document, even if references to them may be sparse depending on how relevant they are to the author.

- Lore and concepts from the novel trilogy are considered canon and relevant, such as explanations involving Remnant or personality traits for characters like William Afton, Henry Emily, and Elizabeth Afton.

That said, it also is meant to be a story of its own, about the grief of a father and the terror of learning about the nature of this franchise's antagonists. I encourage you to read this with the mindset of if this was an actual FNAF book, as well as a narrative of its own.

I'd like to thank my friends from Fright's Dome, a personal server I run. A lot of them are devoted, passionate fans of this franchise, and they helped me by proofreading and offering suggestions when they could.

I would like to specifically thank Puppy, Funk E., Corpregi, Penny, Dioxide, Ceyarma, Dazenza, Penrose, Ash, Dario, Amara, Yankee, MainGameCentral, and Entom. Thank you for proofreading and helping me make sure this story could be as high quality as possible.

If you're confused on any of this, have noticed an error (particularly an objective error, not something that doesn't align with personal theory), or just have general thoughts you'd like to share, my Twitter is *@m0nologue*, and you can also contact me on Discord at *m0nologue.* I'm fairly active in the Freddit Discord server.

FONTS

This story is intended to emulate the pacing and style of other Five Nights at Freddy's merchandise, such as the Survival Logbook, the Character Encyclopedia, and the various versions of The Freddy Files. Thus, I will use different fonts to denote different text.

Bolded, centered, and larger Arial defines chapter and section headers. This text is out-of-universe and does not exist in-universe as part of the notes; it is purely for the sake of organization.

Normal Arial defines the author's text. The author wrote this book over several years, from 1986 to 2023. Note that this text defines *written text* - the author wrote this by hand.

Consolas defines typed text, rather than written. This text is still from the author, but it was transcribed digitally, and appears only in the final act of the story.

Franklin Gothic defines text from a third party.

Times New Roman defines ulterior text from sources outside of the notes themselves. For the sake of formatting, this text is smaller. This text is often from newspaper clippings, transcripts, or other sources that are pasted into the notes in-universe.

(Bolded and italicized Times New Roman defines out-of-universe text describing a visual element of the book. If this document were a fully-realized FNAF book, this text would be replaced with the visual media it describes. It is only for the reader's convenience.)

Thank you for reading, and I hope you enjoy.

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PROLOGUE

06/26/1986

It has been exactly a year since the Missing Children Incident in Hurricane, Utah.

I've begun to compile some notes in an attempt to visualize evidence and various events that have occurred over the past few years. Previously I've been working with a corkboard and pins, but I just need to get these thoughts out on paper.

Washington County has seen a lot of tragedy in recent years. Death looms over this place like a rolling thunder. It was invited here by a man who has evaded arrest ever since he took his first victim in 1983. A depraved parasite using a children's restaurant as a cover.

(A photograph of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. The restaurant is empty, and the lot is overtaken by weeds and tall grass.)

I intend to uncover secrets that have been gnawing at me for a while now. The perpetrator of the Missing Children Incident. Fazbear Entertainment's negligence. The disappearances of security guards watching over the now-empty restaurant.

If things go as I expect, the only person who will read this is me.

I think it best to start with the beginning.

PART 1: 1986

CHAPTER 1: BEGINNINGS

06/27/1986

(A photograph of a welcome board for an establishment named Fredbear's Family Diner.)

MEET FREDBEAR AND SPRINGBONNIE'S GREATEST FRIENDS! Henry Emily and William Afton have worked hard to bring the greatest in entertainment right to the doorstep of New Harmony. It was not so long ago when Henry and his friend Fredbear were looking for fellow band members - what a surprise it was for them when William Afton and his great friend Springbonnie, also looking for work and companionship, met them and devised the unforgettable and affordable experience you're in RIGHT NOW! You can always catch Henry Emily introducing the bear-and-bunny duo on Saturday nights, and William Afton is always hard at work sending out letters for any furry friends who wish to join them on their adventure.

Fredbear's Family Diner was once a hotspot in New Harmony, founded by Henry Emily and William Afton. It enthralled and excited children and parents alike. Its animatronics were, at the time, state-of-the-art - a duo named Fredbear and Springbonnie.

As of the present, it is abandoned. The lot is overflowing with grass. The building's walls are plagued by graffiti. A sign on the door: "DO NOT ENTER." I'm grabbing evidence and concerning materials from the building while I can, as I suspect the company will eventually guard the place more heavily.

Fredbear's Family Diner closed down for a litany of reasons. The first entailed its springlock suits, which were faulty and prone to breaking.

SPRINGLOCK SUITS

06/28/1986

On the surface, springlock suits may seem like they were designed to save Fredbear's Family Diner money. This is incorrect. The springlock suits were very expensive and very difficult to make. The main purpose of the springlock suits was to entice potential investors and establish the founders of Fredbear's Family Diner as revolutionary roboticists.

The initial designs were conceptualized by William Afton, co-founder of Fazbear Enterprises.

Afton had spent years prior to the founding of Fredbear's Family Diner attempting to market this project to investors. He required funding, but no investors were interested in the project.

(Blueprint detailing the operation of the Springlock Mascot Suit Endo-00. The blueprint describes that the suit can be used as both a mascot suit and an individual, autonomous endoskeleton, capable of rudimentary movement. The suit transitions from one process to the other via opening the suit and individually cranking its springlocks, a lengthy process. The blueprint has a singular credit, William Afton.)

After Afton met Henry Emily, the two formed a partnership and began to develop an improved iteration of the springlock suit.

(Blueprint detailing the operation of the Springlock Mascot Suit Endo-01. The blueprint now specifies that the springlock suit can be transitioned from suit to animatronic by inserting a crank into various mechanisms of the suit, thus no longer requiring the operator to open the suit. The blueprint has two springlock suits, built for mascot suits of a bear and a rabbit. These suits are named, respectively, "RXP-001" and "RXQ-001." The blueprint is credited to "Afton and Emily, Inc.")

Due to the nature of the springlock suit, it cannot be detached from the fabric suit itself, a design flaw that would later be addressed. Afton and Emily only had the funds to create two of these suits - these suits would be fixed up and developed into the mascot characters Fredbear and Springbonnie.

(Patent filed for the Springlock Mascot Suit Endo-01. Filed in 1978.)

(Note: Getting tired. Recounting the past is painful.)

06/30/1986

After Fredbear's Family Diner was founded in 1980 and received unexpectedly enthusiastic attention, Afton and Emily had gained the funds to hire staff for the establishment as well as create additional springlock suits.

(A photograph of a form, taken inside Fredbear's Family Diner.)
FREDBEAR'S FAMILY DINER FIRST AID LOG
It is our policy that all injuries inflicted on employees are reported, no matter how minor.

Date	***Name***	***Nature of injury***	***Severity***	***Action taken***
04/13/82	*Ken Strout*	*Springlock failure, right arm*	*Minor scratch*	*Gave band-aid*
06/02/82	*Bill Stanton*	*Slipped on spilled soda, banged head*	*Could be serious*	*Sent home*
09/21/82	*Jennifer Connolly*	*Springlock failure, leg and torso*	*Leg serious, torso light cut*	*Called ambulance*
02/14/83	*John Althist*	*Springlock failure, hand*	*Serious*	*Called ambulance*
[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	*God help us.*

The springlock suits were initially seen as revolutionary, but slowly began to gain the reputation of dangerous death traps. The springlocks in the suits were prone to failure while in the “suit mode,” resulting in pieces of the endoskeleton snapping back into place.

Multiple springlock failures occurred over the course of the diner’s tenure from 1980-1983. None were disastrous enough to result in a death, but they were enough to have the Endo-01 models discontinued and replaced with the Endo-02 model. These were used for only two years before springlock suits as a whole were discontinued permanently as a result of a full-body springlock failure killing an employee at a sister location to Freddy Fazbear’s Pizza.

Also contributing to the closure of Fredbear’s Family Diner was an incident regarding William Afton’s two sons.

THE BITE OF ‘83

(This page is torn from the notes. Only scraps remain.)

On tercation occurred between four teenagers and a young boy. fton and his older brother, Michael Afton (now Mike Schmidt). The t had lifted the boy into the Fredbear animatronic’s mouth. Due to the the jaw forcefully clamped down onto head. The diner was eva boy was rushed to the nearest h in St. George. Michael and anslaughter. The tragedy had a rippl armony and recei ttention for the town.

allegations of faulty technology followed. The incident sparked William Afton’s orce with his wife, and the development of the Security Puppet.

FAZBEAR ENTERTAINMENT

06/30/1986

In January 1981, Henry Emily founded Fazbear Enterprises, a company designed to expand the brand he and Afton had created. Following this, two announcements were made:

1. A new restaurant in Hurricane, known as Freddy Fazbear's Pizza
2. The unveiling of a new endoskeleton model, known as the "A&E Mascot Endo-X", which would be used for the animatronic mascots in Freddy Fazbear's Pizza

Shortly before Freddy Fazbear's Pizza opened in Hurricane, Fazbear Entertainment was also founded - Fazbear Entertainment was a subsidiary of Fazbear Enterprises, focused mainly on the operation of restaurants.

The establishment of Fazbear Enterprises would begin a domino-effect that would end in Emily refocusing his efforts towards Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, leaving Afton to the management of Fredbear's Family Diner. Later in February, Afton founded Afton Robotics LLC, a robotics engineering company that was closely related to Fazbear Enterprises. It is speculated that Afton lost interest in managing Fredbear's Family Diner in 1983, resulting in negligence. Accidents among the staff and mistakes made during show performances went up exponentially as Afton managed the establishment alone.

After the massive success of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, additional restaurants were built across the Midwest. Fazbear Media was also founded - another subsidiary dedicated to the production of merchandise and fiction for the Freddy Fazbear brand.

During this period, additional springlock suits were developed for Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, so that Fredbear and Springbonnie could make "guest performances" at the restaurant. Future Endo-02 springlock models would eventually be made for all Freddy's locations across America before they were all discontinued in 1985.

(Excerpt from an interview between William Afton and HUTV News in 1986.)

"Ah yes, the prototypes. That takes me back [...] after I received my degree and I settled down with my wife, I'd finalized the design, or so I thought at the time, but I needed money. And times weren't the best back then [...] no one was interested in it, for one. Said the animatronic stuff was a fad… plus they just weren't feasible. I was never able to fully produce one - eventually I met Henry Emily and we ended up designing the springlock suits together. [...] Of course, that was a mistake of its own."

THE DEATH OF CHARLOTTE EMILY

(The following page is crumpled-up and torn. It seems to have been picked back up later, flattened back out, and re-added to the notes.)

06/30/1986

Fredbear's Family Diner announced its closure in 1983 following the death of Afton's youngest son. The establishment would operate until October 31st, 1983, in coordination with Fallfest, before finally shutting down.

On October 31st, the police were called by William Afton, who had been managing the establishment that night. Afton reported that a child had been murdered outside of the building, having been found alongside the remains of the defunct Security Puppet animatronic.

(Note: I can't do this. I can't write this.)

07/05/1986

(The following is a photograph of an autopsy report.)

Age	*Race*	*Sex*	*Height*	*Weight*	*Eyes*	*Hair*	*Blood*
3	*Caucasian*	*F*	*3.3 ft*	*30.5 lb.*	*Brown*	*Brown*	*AB*

(A diagram labeled "Marks and Wounds," depicting two views of the female body - one from the front, one from the back.

A marking is drawn on the left temple. It is labeled "Fractured skull".

A marking is drawn on the neck. It is labeled "Bruising, suggests strangulation; strangulation was not cause of death".

A marking is drawn on the left hand. It is labeled "Light bruising; not consistent with bruises on neck; markings consistent with hands of animatronic".

Multiple markings are drawn on the torso. They are labeled "Stab wounds; 12 in total; ranging from 3 to 4 inches deep; most likely with a small kitchen knife.")

Probable Cause of Death
Blood loss.

MISCELLANEOUS

07/07/1986

(A series of collected legal documents.)

UTAH WASHINGTON JUDICIAL COURT
DIVORCE PROCEEDINGS
GRACE v HENRY EMILY

UTAH WASHINGTON JUDICIAL COURT
DIVORCE PROCEEDINGS
[redacted] v WILLIAM AFTON

UTAH WASHINGTON JUDICIAL COURT
LEGAL CUSTODY AGREEMENT
[redacted] v WILLIAM AFTON
For the custody of MICHAEL and ELIZABETH AFTON

UTAH WASHINGTON JUDICIAL COURT
LEGAL CUSTODY AGREEMENT
GRACE v HENRY EMILY
For the custody of SAMUEL EMILY

(At least I had you, friend.)

(A document from Fredbear's Family Diner.)

GET TO KNOW THE SECURITY PUPPET!

The Security Puppet is the newest addition to the Fredbear's family. His real name is "SP-001", made by Afton Robotics™. The Security Puppet is state-of-the-art and all about safety.

The Security Puppet is outfitted with cameras and an experimental, autonomous movement system!

Terminal: Use the terminal in the security office to give orders to the Security Puppet! If he sees anything out of the ordinary, he can transmit reports and alerts to your terminal. Consult the manual for more information.

Bracelets: All children in Fredbear's Family Diner are given a colored bracelet. These bracelets identify them to the Security Puppet, who can keep an eye on all patrons to ensure their safety. When operating the terminal, use bracelets to identify patrons!

Security Box: The Security Puppet's home is in the Security Box, where it will peek out and keep watch over patrons. If so desired, use the terminal to control the Puppet's cameras. When set in "play" mode, the Security Puppet can wave to children.

Movement system: This system is experimental and thus cannot be controlled from the terminal. In the event that a child with a prioritized bracelet is seen to be out-of-bounds (such as on the stage), the Security Puppet can walk to the child and play a message, comforting the child. It will transmit an alert to the terminal.*

Please take full advantage of the Security Puppet to keep all Fredbear's children safe!

** Message is as follows: "Come with me! It will be okay."*

The Security Puppet was discontinued by Afton Robotics in early 1984, due to low market expectations. Its failure to save Charlotte from her death resulted in controversy for Afton Robotics that it wouldn't recover from until years later. Henry Emily stepped down from his position as CEO of Fazbear Entertainment a week later.

CHAPTER 2: THE MISSING CHILDREN INCIDENT

07/14/1986

On June 26th, 1985, five children disappeared from Freddy Fazbear's Pizza.

I am lucky to have a friend in the police department. Thanks to him, I have some degree of knowledge as to how the police handled the Missing Children Incident. I'm posting my findings here, in an attempt to visualize the evidence and materials I have. If I look at this from a different angle, perhaps I can understand.

SUSPECTS

07/14/1986

(A list of suspects is shown across multiple documents.)

William Afton, age 40: *Co-founder of Fredbear's Family Diner. Close friend to Henry Emily. Divorced his wife in 1983 following his youngest son's death; his wife took his oldest son. His daughter also disappeared early June.*

Afton claims to have not been present at Freddy's during the time period in which the individual wearing the mascot suit is seen on the cameras. Afton Robotics employees who were interviewed claim Afton was working at their factory in New Harmony, but I don't know if I trust this claim.

Afton's close ties with Freddy Fazbear's Pizza and its management line up with the case. Whoever wore the mascot suit was able to get it out of the "safe room," which is a privilege only higher-up employees have. Searching Afton's home, it is clear that he is obsessed with the mascot suit used in the crime.

Jonathon Calden, age 32: *High-ranking employee at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. Was initially hired at Afton Robotics before being transferred to Freddy Fazbear's Pizza as a specialist. Calden trained fellow staff on proper usage of the springlock suits.*

Calden is a high-strung, nervous man, albeit very intelligent. He is an expert at engineering and operates the animatronics and springlock suits with ease. Calden is not popular with fellow employees - when interviewed, they often mocked him and implied they saw him as "annoying" and "creepy." Many simply forgot his name, calling him "the phone guy."

Calden is considered a serious suspect, alongside Afton.

Henry Emily, age 39: *Founder of Fazbear Entertainment and co-founder of Fredbear's Family Diner. Close friend of William Afton.*

Many members of the community regard Henry Emily as reclusive and "creepy." He was always shy and typically left public appearances to Afton when it came to managing his business, but his behavior became especially shut-off when his daughter was murdered in 1983 and he stepped down from CEO of Fazbear Entertainment. His wife divorced him soon after, and he lost custody of his son.

Members of the community seem to have picked Henry as the most likely perpetrator of the crime, including multiple parents of the missing children. It is the opinion of the department that Henry is almost certainly innocent. We have no interest in further questioning him.

Mike Schmidt, Age 17: *Formerly Michael Afton. Son of William Afton and* [redacted] *Schmidt, who took back her maiden name after divorcing William.*

Schmidt was arrested in 1983 for the death of [redacted]*. He was charged with manslaughter, but was not convicted thanks to the lack of cameras in Fredbear's Family Diner and the argument in court that the faulty technology of the company's machinery was more to blame for the boy's death than Schmidt himself was. He now lives with his mother in Hurricane.*

Schmidt has been professionally diagnosed with post-traumatic stress disorder, and visits a therapist and psychiatrist bi-weekly. Schmidt was a problem child and was described by classmates in 1983 as a "bully", but after his brother's death, he has become reclusive and speaks very little. The other three delinquent teenagers present during [redacted] *death are no longer in contact with Schmidt.*

Mike Schmidt is only on this list as a formality. Like Henry Emily, we have no further interest in questioning him.

Conclusion: *I find it incredibly likely that the perpetrator is either William Afton or Jonathon Calden.*

- Washington County police chief, Clay Burke

TRANSCRIPT OF CAMERA RECORDING

07/15/1986

The weight and severity of what happened in that restaurant a year ago is not lost on me, but it also has not fully set in yet. I feel only a whisper of the grief I should feel, no doubt because my ability to grieve has already been wracked.

Part of that grief was also aimed toward the Aftons. William had a love for children, for business, for engineering, and that love was exploited and twisted into something horrible. Reading the notes I was given by Mr. Burke (whom I owe my immense gratitude, and my condolences to Carlton, who was friends with the victims), I see that William was considered the prime suspect for his "obsession" with Springbonnie.

But Springbonnie is a character he created. It is a character he imagined in his youth, escapism from his childhood. He has a *right* to feel this way, just as he has a *right* to feel betrayed that some monster would take his vision, his character, and...

...It's simply horrible.

(Police transcript of camera footage from June 26th, 1985.)

9:35 PM: *Security guard switches between cameras at a rough interval of once every 20 seconds - mainly switching between the show stage, main room, and arcade cameras. This continues until 9:42 PM.*

(Editor's note: Camera footage is only available on cameras the security guard's terminal actively watches. The building has a security guard 24/7, two in the day and one at night.)

9:42 PM: *Terminal rests on the arcade room camera for an extended period of time.*

(Editor's note: Around this period, the security guard left the office to use the restroom and briefly speak with another employee.)

A child, identified as Susanne Carter, plays on an arcade machine. Susanne makes body movements indicating that she is crying.

9:43 PM: *Only barely in view, a mascot stares at Susie from behind another arcade machine before approaching her. The mascot's walking suggests that the suit is being worn by a human, not an endoskeleton. The mascot is the "Springbonnie" character.*

(Note: The appearance of the mascot suit is irregular. According to Jonathon Calden, the building's springlock suits had been decommissioned only days prior.)

9:44 PM: *Susanne and the mascot talk. The mascot holds out his hand. Susanne grabs the mascot's hand, and the two walk off-screen. (Editor's note: The cameras do not record audio.)*

9:46 PM: *The camera switches to the main room. (Editor's note: This is when the security guard returned to the office. There are no witnesses who saw the exchange between Susanne and the mascot.)*

The main room is only sparsely populated, as the establishment was holding a private birthday party. Nine (9) children can be seen on the cameras, along with parents conversing at the tables. The main animatronic cast of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza is nowhere to be seen.

(Editor's note: According to Jonathon Calden, the restaurant's animatronic characters were temporarily decommissioned alongside the springlock suits for maintenance.)

9:47-9:48 PM: *Over the next two minutes, the security guard switches cameras routinely. When he switches to the cameras overlooking the bathroom entrances at 9:47, the hand of the mascot character can briefly be seen from the left side of the screen. It appears the guard overlooked this.*

9:49 PM: *The camera switches to the second main room camera, which is located above the show stage, overlooking the back wall of the main room, where the building sells prizes and the Puppet's Prize Box is located. The mascot character can be seen in the distance, leading a child away from the Pirate's Cove area towards the bathrooms. Like the mascot's appearance in the bathroom camera, it appears this was overlooked.*

(Editor's note: The person wearing the mascot suit is deliberately luring children away when parents in the main room are distracted. It is unclear where the children are led to, thanks to poor camera coverage. The child in this shot is speculated to be Jeremy Fitzgerald Jr.)

Shortly after the mascot character and the child disappear from the cameras, artifacts and visual tearing manifest on the camera. Briefly, the Puppet's Prize Box appears to shift open slightly. (Editor's note: One of the others insists he sees the Puppet's hand come out of the box here. My conclusion, he's spooked and seeing things.)

The transcript ends here.

The investigation of the Missing Children Incident began the night it occurred. According to one of the parents, her child told her that she and some of her friends intended to go and play at a playground across the street - thinking nothing of it, this was accepted. Parents went home assuming their children were playing outside, and called the police later that night when it became apparent that this wasn't the case.

It is my opinion that many of the parents acted foolishly and ignorantly. Even if this actually were the case, letting their children play unsupervised and late at night was incompetent parenting. (Not that I'd ever say this to them... I still sympathize.)

I have to wonder if this lie was made up by the man in the Springbonnie suit - if he told this child to lie to her mother. To delay the inevitable investigation.

The police have no clue where the children went. But I have a hunch.

SAFE ROOMS

07/16/1986

Every Fazbear Entertainment establishment (including Fredbear's Family Diner) is installed with a "safe room." Safe rooms are invisible to the digital map layout the animatronics use, not visible on camera, and hidden to customers.

When the safe rooms were first conceptualized, they weren't called "safe rooms." They were "Parts and Service." Fazbear Entertainment didn't like overtly referring to the animatronics as animatronics, preferring to refer to them as if the mascots were living animals - they felt that admitting they were robots to children would scare them.

All maintenance for the animatronics was conducted within hidden Parts and Service rooms invisible to customers, so that this "illusion" were less likely to be broken to child patrons. After Fazbear Entertainment's CEO left later on in 1983, the company's view on this matter changed. Springlock suits were known to be very dangerous, but discontinuing them entirely would have been costly. Franklin Scott, the CEO after Henry Emily's retirement, felt very differently regarding the safe rooms' potential usage.

> ***(Transcript from a company recording by Jonathon Calden in December 1983.)***
>
> *"Uh, hello? Hello! There has been a change of company policy regarding the, uh, Parts and Service rooms. The company has decided that, uh... it would be easier and more cost-effective to build dedicated Parts and Service rooms closer to the stages themselves. It's really a convenience thing, honestly. Now you won't have to bring Freddy and his friends halfway across the restaurant and finagle with a secret door just to pick some pizza out of their teeth, haha.*
>
> *So, uh, you might ask, 'what will happen to the old rooms?' Good question! We are retrofitting these into new, safer rooms. In fact, that-that's what they're called. Safe rooms. We're gonna be using these rooms for a few things, storage mainly, but they're also here in the event of a grievous accident. Uh, with the constant springlock failures at the last location, you know, we just figured if something worse were to happen we need a place to control the situation. Imagine if a kid saw something like that... um...*
>
> *So, if something like that were to ever happen again, which it won't, but if it did, that's what the safe room is for. The company asks that you do not mention the safe room to patrons, family, friends, or insurance representatives. Thank you, and, you know, smile! You are the face of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza."*

I am of the opinion that whoever was inside that suit lured the children into the safe room.

God only knows what he did to them. All I know is, they never left. If those children were killed inside that restaurant, their bodies are still there. Either that, or the company disposed of them.

After what I've seen from them? I would not be surprised.

COURT TRIAL

07/17/1986

(A photograph of a newspaper clipping. Only the headline is visible. "WILLIAM AFTON FOUND INNOCENT.")

(Excerpt from trial transcript.)

William Afton takes the stand and is examined by the prosecution, Felix McDonagh.

Q: Will you state your name for the record, please?

A: William Charles Afton.

Q: Are you the defendant in this case?

A: Yes.

Q: Are you aware of what offense you have been charged with, Mr. Afton?

A: Yes.

Q: You were initially asked as to your activities on June 26th, 1985, and responded that you were in New Harmony. Can you describe, in detail, your activities on this day?

*A: I can, though I must provide context first. As some here may know, I am the founder and CEO of Afton Robotics, an animatronic engineering company. Over the past year, we have marketed and prepared for the launch of an entertainment complex known as Circus Baby's Pizza World, which is stationed in Hurricane. On June 13th, my company launched a "test trial" for the establishment, which was exclusive to local subscribers of our magazine. The test trial ended in disaster. Multiple gas leaks were reported thanks to faulty construction by the previous owners of the lot that we purchased. The commotion resulted in the malfunction of our star animatronic, and a fatal injury to one of our staff, Craig Morgan - God rest his soul.**

Q: How does this relate to June 26th?

A: Ever since the incident on June 13th, I have been indisposed. I have been tirelessly working with my employees on repairing our state-of-the-art animatronic, on top of running repairs to the building itself. The accident has cost us dearly. On June 26th, I was at Circus Baby's Pizza World, in Hurricane.

Q: According to the employees working there that day, you were only there from 6 AM to 2 PM. Where did you go after you left?

A: I was returning to New Harmony, where I live. I stopped at my home to... grieve, then I left for the Afton Robotics factory.

Q: To grieve. I assume for your daughter.

A: Yes. I find it distasteful and offensive to bring this into the court. My daughter, Elizabeth, disappeared only a day after the incident on the 13th. The parents I see in this room are not the only ones who have lost children.

Q: And the Afton Robotics factory?

A: We purchased the building from Hadcappe last year in November. We hope for it to be one of three factories in the Midwest.

Q: How long were you at this factory?

A: I arrived at my home at 3:02 PM. I left at 6:15 PM. I arrived at my factory at 6:41 PM, and stayed there until 2:46 AM, when I left to go back home.

Q: Those are very specific times, Mr. Afton.

A: I am a very punctual man, Mr. McDonagh.

* A note: Craig Morgan was an Afton Robotics employee who died the day the gas leaks occurred at Circus Baby's Pizza World. The official story is that the gas leaks caused the springlock suit to malfunction. It caused the springlocks along the back of the suit to trigger and eviscerate Morgan's back. William was busy tending to Circus Baby's malfunction in the main room (did he ever explain what exactly it was?) and the families were being evacuated by the employees. The convulsions from Morgan's injury resulted in additional springlocks along the legs, arms, and facial regions to trigger as well.

Morgan ultimately died of exsanguination and wasn't discovered until after the evacuation.

RELICS

07/18/1986

(A photograph of a child's drawing. It depicts a small child holding hands with a large yellow rabbit. It reads: "ME AND MY FRIEND.")

(A photograph of a child's drawing. The entirety of the page is scrawled in black crayon, save for two white dots in the middle of the page.
Another photograph of the other side. Scrawled in large, uneven lettering: "IT'S ME.")

(A photograph of a collection of tapes, taken in 1986. The tapes are in a desk drawer labeled "CALDEN - SPRINGLOCK SUIT TRAINING TAPES." There are over a dozen tapes, labeled various dates from 1980 to 1985. There are supposed to be training tapes from the month of June 1985, but they are missing.)

(A missing person poster. A photo of a smiling child is shown. He is a boy with dark skin and short hair.)

MISSING CHILD
HAVE YOU SEEN THIS CHILD?
GABRIEL WEST
Age: 7
DOB: 06/26/1978
Height: 4'2
Weight: 52lbs
Victim was wearing a yellow polo shirt, tan shorts, a red baseball cap, red shoes, and a blue wristwatch.
Missing from: 230 Prince Ave. | Missing since: 06/26/1985
Last seen at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. If seen, please contact the Washington County Police Department.
(435)-555-4999

(A newspaper clipping.)
KIDS VANISH AT LOCAL PIZZERIA - BODIES NOT FOUND.
Two local children were reportedly lured into a back room during the late hours of operation at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza on the night of June 26th. Video surveillance has identified the perpetrator as a man wearing a company mascot's suit. Police think the man wore this suit to earn the children's trust.
Police have taken local entrepreneur William Afton into custody, but have declined to comment.

(A newspaper clipping.)
FIVE CHILDREN NOW REPORTED MISSING. SUSPECT CHARGED.
Five children are now linked to the incident at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, where a man dressed as a cartoon mascot reportedly lured them into a back room. All five children have not been found and are presumed dead.
Prime suspect William Afton has been charged with five counts of first-degree murder, and is expected to go to trial later this month.
Fazbear Entertainment has been fighting an uphill battle in the last week to fight the publicity the incident has garnered. CEO Franklin Scott commented: "It's a tragedy."

(A pamphlet from Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, dated 1984.)
FIND US ACROSS THE MIDWEST!
Freddy and his friends love to travel. You can meet them at the following locations:
Hurricane, UT (YOU ARE HERE!)
Ozark, MO
Toledo, OH
Madison, MN
Saginaw, MI
But it doesn't stop here. Stay tuned for even more fantasy and fun at our sister locations:
Circus Baby's Pizza World - Hurricane, UT (Est. 1985)
Chica's Party World - St. George, UT (Est. 1985)
Remember: This band keeps rockin', forever and ever!

List of victims:
- Gabriel West
- Jeremy Fitzgerald Jr.
- Susie Carter
- Fritz Smith Jr.
- Cassidy Miller

CHAPTER 3: VARIOUS DISAPPEARANCES

07/25/1986

(Torn pieces of a missing children poster.)

MISSING CHIL
HAVE YOU SEEN THIS C
ANDREW
Age: 9
DOB: 02/13/197
Height: 4'5

Victim was weari
Missing fro
Missing s
olice Department.

I'm not quite sure how relevant these details are. Perhaps they are not at all, or perhaps the mystery surrounding the Missing Children Incident runs deeper than I previously thought.

Based on the events that have passed since the Missing Children Incident, I have come to three conclusions.

1. The man who killed those children also killed Charlotte.
2. This man is still at large, and may be actively kidnapping / murdering people across Washington County.
3. Fazbear Entertainment is either colluding with this man, or actively covering up his crimes.

I have to address the things that have led me to believe this.

FORGOTTEN CHILD

07/25/1986

There were more lives lost to this monster than the five in Freddy's. The first, I only have limited information for.

A child in rural Washington County went missing, roughly, during the same time period as the Missing Children Incident. Information on this has proven to be remarkably scarce. From what I've been able to scrounge up, the boy was recorded missing roughly five days after the Missing Children Incident, on June 31st, 1985. Evidence seems to suggest the boy went missing the same night, however for some reason his father took almost a week to file a missing person's report.

I visited his family's home, and was able to speak briefly with his brother. I've included a transcript.

(A transcript of a recording.)

(Sound of myself knocking on the front door.)

(Brief silence. The recorder doesn't catch this, but I distinctly remember hearing a man's voice yell "Answer the damn door.")

(The door opens. The man who answers seems to be a young adult, early 20s. Will be referred to as J for this transcript.)

J: Yeah, what's up?

(I respond.)

H: Hi, I'm... my name is Henry. Henry Emily.

J: Never heard of you. What do you want?

H: ...I'm here to ask you some questions about a boy that went missing a little more than a year ago. A boy who lived here.

(Brief silence. J's voice lowers a bit.)

J: What was his name?

H: Wh-what?

J: Tell me his name. We get types like you sometimes. You don't actually care. You just want to sensationalize it. You-you don't see a boy who left a family behind. You see a casualty to make a story out of. Get lost.

(J turns to close the door.)

H: Andrew. His name was Andrew.

(Brief silence.)

H: This isn't about me. I'm not writing a story, and I'm not a journalist. I... I lost my daughter three years ago, to the same man I suspect killed Andrew.

(J turns back to me, steps outside, and closes the door behind him. Briefly, I see an older man around my age in the house, sitting on a chair in their living room. I now suspect J is Andrew's brother.)

J: What do you want to know?

H: I have a few questions. I guess I want to know... what you think happened.

(J sighs.)

J: I was supposed to watch him. I let him sneak off to that restaurant in Hurricane... we live, like, right by the border, so he only had to walk like 20 minutes. Andrew already ran from home all the time, and he always came back. Dad was out screwing around, doing whatever Dad does when he's not drinking his ass off. And he-

(J coughs, sighs.)

J: Andrew had it rough. Not your business why. But he wasn't happy. And Freddy's made him happy. So I let him run off. He told me his friend's birthday party was happening there, and I knew for a fact Andrew didn't have any friends-

H: So Andrew was unpopular?

J: No. Yeah- The poor kid just didn't know how to manage his emotions. He learned it from his dad. Maybe he was trying to make friends.

H: I see. And he never came back?

J: Actually, he did. Couple hours later and he was back, around 9. Told me he'd got to see his friend, and that he was gonna visit him again sometime. He... he disappeared after he went to bed. Dad came home, knocked on the door, got pissed that it was locked... stomped off outside to get in through the window, except the window was shattered and Andrew was gone. He swore he saw footprints out there, but what he said didn't make any sense, and they'd washed off in the rain by the time I got out there.

H: How did the footprints not make any sense?

J: He said he saw animal tracks out there.

(Brief silence. I ponder this for a minute.)

H: Was there a search party?

J: Dad and I went out there and looked. Searched practically the whole damn forest, but we never found him. We both assumed he ran off to Freddy's again, probably to meet this friend of his or whatever. But we never saw him again. It took Dad almost a week to file a report. He kept saying Andrew would be back.

H: I'm... I'm sincerely sorry for your loss. I would give anything to see my daughter again. I'm sure both of you would as well to see Andrew.

J: Well... I would, at least.

(J sighs.)

J: Nobody... really cares that he's gone. Everyone was so focused on those kids at Freddy's who disappeared. And I-I get that, that's awful. But my brother's gone, too. And just because he wasn't in that stupid restaurant, he's not "Andrew" anymore. He's just... "missing child."

H: I understand. I'm sorry. I sincerely hope your brother is at peace.

J: Yeah. Thanks.

(I turn to leave. Before I leave, I turn back, and catch J before he goes back inside.)

H: I have one more question. You mentioned that Andrew said he had a friend he wanted to meet - a friend he made at Freddy's. Did he mention this friend's name?

J: Uh, yeah. I think it was Bonnie.

These notes are not intended to be seen by anyone but myself. But in the event that someone else sees these - I want it to be known that a sixth child was stolen from their family that night. His name was Andrew.

He was loved.

ELIZABETH AFTON

07/26/1986

Another child went missing around this same period of time. As mentioned previously in William Afton's court trial excerpt, William lost his daughter only weeks before the Missing Children Incident.

Elizabeth Afton was William Afton's only daughter. She was the middle child. I had the pleasure of knowing all of William's children, whom I am proud to call my nieces and nephews.

Elizabeth was very intelligent for her age. I have no doubt that, had her chance to grow up not been stolen from her, she'd have been a genius like her father. She was enthralled by the machines we created together, in contrast to her younger brother who wanted nothing to do with them.

Her life was taken from her on June 14th, 1985.

(Photograph of a family photo of the Afton family. William and his wife stand in the back, while their three children stand in the front; Michael to the right, his brother to the left, and Elizabeth between the two of them. William's right hand rests on his youngest son's head, ruffling his hair; his left hand rests on his daughter's shoulder. Both of his wife's hands are on Michael's shoulders.

Everyone is smiling.)

When William told me what had happened, he was devastated. Like Andrew, Elizabeth had been snatched from her home. In the dead of night, someone had broken into the house while he and his daughter slept, and kidnapped Elizabeth from her bedroom. William woke too late. His daughter was already gone.

This happened only a day after the disaster at Circus Baby's Pizza World. I suspect the killer may have had somewhat of a vendetta against William, and perhaps against me as well. Before he killed the ~~five~~ six children on June 26th, he murdered our daughters.

Who could hate us that much? What kind of person does this?

I would be alone, if not for William. My friend is one of the only sources of light remaining in my life, but even that has become dim.

He has closed himself off from me. William and I have been friends for years. Close to a decade. When we first met in that bar, I felt something within minutes. Something electrifying. Kinship. Brotherhood. I saw loneliness. I saw emptiness... the same emptiness that was in me before I met Grace, before I looked into my daughter's eyes for the first time.

I wanted to... help him. Help him find the light in his life that I had. He was in an unhappy marriage, with three children.

When he sheepishly showed me his prototypes for a contraption only a week later, some kind of suit, that was the first time that I saw something resembling happiness in his eyes. If I couldn't heal William's family, I could at least heal his career. And my own, as well - I was an engineer. A roboticist, like him.

But I seldom see that passion behind his eyes now. I was there, at the court trial, where people slung accusations at William of murdering children. The world has failed my friend. Just as I failed my daughter. The grief I feel for my friend cannot be understated. And admiration. William experienced the loss I felt two-fold, in less than two years, and yet he still manages to run Afton Robotics efficiently. Unlike me, he did not run.

He is a stronger man than I am.

SECURITY GUARDS

07/27/1986

If I were to share these notes to people more experienced in these kinds of investigations, I imagine I'd be considered a bit crazy. I find myself returning to these notes quite often.

~~It feels as if I'm being guided. Sometimes, I dream of an alien presence watching me. It puts its hand over mine like my mother would. It puts a pen in my hand. It tells me, "Write." But what is there to write? I am the shadow of a man who died with his daughter. I have nothing to write ab~~

I suppose I just need to get my thoughts onto paper.

Freddy Fazbear's Pizza (at least, the restaurant in Hurricane) closed down almost immediately after the Missing Children Incident, and as of writing it has yet to be reopened. But Fazbear Entertainment isn't close to going bankrupt anytime soon - some of their other locations are thriving, and they seem to have struck gold with that television show. I suspect they have plans to *eventually* reopen that place. I know this because they still have people guarding the building, and those animatronics are still inside. Not only do they still have people guard the building... they seem to have a high turnover rate.

I have to admit that I've been visiting Freddy's occasionally. I've visited it maybe eight times since the incident. It's... like something washes over me. Unawareness. I find my feet taking me to my car, my hands steering the wheel, bringing me to Freddy's.

Each time I've sat in my car for quite a while, staring at the unlit sign. Staring at the front door. On maybe four occasions, a security guard has confronted me.

Each time, it was a different security guard.

The last time I went to Freddy's, I found my feet taking me to the front door. Before I could reach it, the night guard came out to greet me. Distressed. Angry, too. He yelled, *"What are you doing here!?"*

I stammered. What *have* I been doing here? ~~What should I have said? That I feel linked to this place? As if part of my soul is in there, waiting for me to find it?~~

"You can't be here," he said. *"This is private property, and..."*

He looked back to the building. I noticed that I could see dim lights moving inside. He said: *"Listen, you need to leave, now. It isn't safe, and I could get in a lot of trouble."*

I stared at him. I struggled to speak.

"Leave, or I'm calling the cops."

I haven't gone back since.

In my excursions to Freddy's, I was confused by how often the guards seemed to leave the job, others hired in their place. After doing some digging I've concluded that a sizable number of the night guards who've worked at Freddy's have disappeared, with some being found dead later. The ones who haven't quit within a month of starting.

(Scribbled, disorganized notes.)

James Yeary - 27, disappeared 7-2-85. Last seen driving to Freddy's, 11:30 PM

Sam Fletcher - 23, disappeared 10-15-85. Mom said she hadn't seen her since her birthday; guards work mon-fri 12-6 AM

Jacob Monroe - 32, disappeared 3-8-86. Body found in forest outside Hurricane; eyes and teeth were missing. Police say "bear attack" - he worked a Freddy's night shift two days beforehand

Alex Kaiden - 39, disappeared 6-24-86. Body later found in apartment - police say he committed suicide by firearm. Face was unrecognizable. Worked the night shift for two months beforehand

Maybe I am crazy. But all four of these people worked at that place, worked the night shift, and disappeared around the timeframe they should have been working there. The latter two were later found dead outside Hurricane, but I...

I just know something happened to them at Freddy's.

(Torn-out page of a notebook.)

I have to log my dreams now. They have grown from unsettling to disturbing.

I sit inside the security office of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza - the restaurant is abandoned. I search the cameras and find that all of the animatronics are missing. I look down the left hallway and find the silhouette of a mascot. It is Bonnie, but I cannot make out his colors.

I look down the right hallway. I see nothing. Sudden paranoia shakes me. I turn back to the left hallway, and I slam the door shut. I know he is coming. As I hold the doorknob shut, I see the reflection of myself in the mirror. I am not me - I am Alex Kaiden, the night guard who confronted me that night.

And I see the reflection of something else.

Bonnie is already inside.

I begin to scream, and the mascot attacks me.

I wake up in a blind sweat.

I do not believe Alex Kaiden killed himself.

Whoever is wearing the Springbonnie suit still visits Freddy's. Like I have. He's taken more victims, and the company is covering it up. I know it.

I know it.

A DREAM, PART 1

07/30/1986

(Torn-out page of a notebook.)

Another dream.

The thing is back. This force. It puts its hand over my hand again. It tells me to write. It says that I cannot give up. That tomorrow is another day.

This time I don't. I clench my fist. I stand up and I look at the thing. But all I can see are two white dots in the darkness. They blink at me and tell me I can't escape. I ask where we are.

Its hands glide along the darkness. Long, dark fingers. Light illuminates and I see we are inside of a large box. The thing speaks again. I can see its face now.

It is the Puppet.

It says it has a gift for me. Its fingers reach to its mask. Its fingers pry and pull. Hair begins to flow from behind the mask. Long, brown hair. I scream. I try to flee but the box gets smaller. The thing grabs me with one hand as it pries its mask off with the other. You must see, it says. You must.

Its hand clenches around me. I scream and punch the creature, and the world falls apart around me. I must escape.

You can't, it says.

And then I'm awake... and on my arm I feel the weight of the Puppet's hand.

DESPAIR

07/30/1986

It has been three years since Grace left.
Three years since Samuel left.
Three years since Charlotte left.

Compiling these notes has done nothing but bring me terrible dreams. I thought I could find some peace if I... tried to *solve* it, I suppose. I thought if I could figure it out, I could find peace. I could accept that she's gone. I want to know who killed my daughter. I want to know who killed those children. Is there any meaning to this? I've lost everything I held dear to my heart.

And these nightmares continue to plague me. They feel familiar yet completely alien. I feel as if I've lost a part of myself. A part I'll never get back. Because it's still inside Freddy's.

In the Puppet's music box.

I am shaken and horrified. I feel just as horrible as the day she died. The eyes of the Puppet continue to gaze into mine. I feel like I have contacted something terrible. It wants me to write. It wants me to investigate.

I will not.

I'm done.

PART 2: 1987-2005

CHAPTER 4: NEW AND IMPROVED

10/29/1987

They've opened another restaurant. Out in St. George.

I told myself I was done. And true to my word I haven't touched these notes. Until now. Something about that place irks me.

It more than irks me. It infuriates me. More than the rest of it. This isn't even close to the first time they've expanded. There are almost ten Freddy Fazbear's Pizzas in America now. And even more sister locations. *This* Freddy's was going to be Chica's Party World.

Does it make me a narcissist to say they've made my creations look cheap?

10/30/1987

I've spoken with William. It's been a while. We've grown apart. I had to sit in the waiting room outside his office - nobody there recognized my name.

William greeted me warmly, but things felt... different. Just a little bit colder. We spoke for quite a while, and not a lot of it is interesting enough to put here. I did inquire about the new Freddy's in St. George, though.

The dreams haven't come back. Perhaps they are gone.

I feel it necessary to write some about Afton Robotics. Just to clear my head.

AFTON ROBOTICS LLC

10/30/1987

Afton Robotics LLC was founded in February 1981, by William Afton.

The company's priorities have changed a bit over the years. Originally it was an animatronics manufacturing company, a "sister company" of sorts to Fazbear Entertainment. There've always been rumors that Fazbear Entertainment and Afton Robotics were almost rivals, like William and I made these companies out of spite for each other - they're wrong. They were our attempts to fulfill our own wishes for our careers without splitting apart entirely. Similarly, Afton Robotics isn't a subsidiary of Fazbear Enterprises. It's an entirely separate company, though William has the rights to use the likenesses of Freddy and the other mascots.

(A form titled "AFTON ROBOTICS, LLC - CLIENT INVOICE.")

Billed To Fazbear Entertainment
214 Pillars Drive
Madison, MN 56256

Invoice Total
$ [redacted]

Invoice Number [redacted]
Date Of Issue 02/21/82

Description	*Unit Cost*	*Qty / Hr. Rate*	*Amount*
A&E Mascot Endo-X *FF-012 + Microphone add-on + Accessories*	*$* [redacted]	*1*	*1*
A&E Mascot Endo-X *BB-012 + Guitar add-on + Accessories*	*$* [redacted]	*1*	*1*
A&E Mascot Endo-X *CC-012 + Cupcake add-on + Accessories*	*$* [redacted]	*1*	*1*
A&E Mascot Endo-X *FP-012 + Accessories*	*$* [redacted]	*1*	*1*
A&E Endo-X *XX-000 + Spare parts*	*$* [redacted]	*1*	*2*
A&E Mascot Suit *XX-000 + Customization kit*	*$* [redacted]	*1*	*4*

Subtotal *$* [redacted]
Tax *$* [redacted]
Total *$* [redacted]

Afton Robotics did contracting work. Fazbear Entertainment pays them to manufacture their animatronics and other technology. They specialize in endoskeletons and other mascot tech, but they also work in general engineering and computers. I am a roboticist, but I only build mascots with my own hands, which William and I did for the first two springlock suits. This isn't feasible when you have many restaurants across the Midwest, so a more automated solution was required.

I take pride in having built Freddy Fazbear and the other three Freddy's mascots. But my involvement with Fazbear Entertainment - in terms of building machinery, anyway - ends there.

I inquired as to the purpose of this new pizzeria in St. George. The town is only a 20 minute drive from Hurricane - why build an entirely new restaurant there? William told me Fazbear Entertainment expressed a wish to rebrand their characters and start their presence in Utah anew. He said they weren't soft enough. Too edgy after what happened two years ago.

I was honest. I said they looked horrible. He laughed. *"I know. But business is business, right?"*

I had also been informed of technological advancements. William said the Endo-X was old news - the X2 is new and excites the company.

(Blueprint detailing the construction and usage of the Afton Robotics Mascot Endo-X2. The blueprint emphasizes the sleek, simpler architecture of the endoskeleton, easily detachable limbs, and the ability to connect to wireless networks.

A second page details the process of wireless connection through a network product family called "AltoNET." Features listed here include remote control of animatronic performances and facial recognition software.)

He said that AltoNET could revolutionize the security process I initially tried with the Security Puppet at Fredbear's, with facial recognition and wireless communication.

"With this, the animatronics can scan the faces of all patrons in the restaurant. They can keep a record of anyone who's visited. If we can get the support, they could even scan police databases." He said they could tell, just from one glance from Freddy Fazbear, if a man in the restaurant is a criminal - a murderer, a fugitive... complete and utter safety, he said.

I'll believe it when I see it.

My visit with William was cut short before I could ask more questions. He told me he's taking a vacation to Aruba. A celebration of their success with the Endo-X2s. I wish him well.

BREAKING AND ENTERING

10/31/1987

It's been four years.
I love you, sweetie. I wish I could see you again.
But I'm not strong enough.

I visited Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. The sign says "new and improved" - half of this is correct. It sure is new. The entrance fee was also nearly double what it was at *my* restaurant. Is this what they've done to all of them?

The mascots look cheap, like they're made of plastic. They look almost exactly like the toys we gave out at the original Freddy's. Foxy looks completely different - "Funtime Foxy," they call him. Or is it her now? Either way, she's a mess of endoskeleton parts now, and his red has been swapped out for white.

Don't even get me started on whatever that thing is that's holding the "Balloons!" sign.

I wasn't there for very long, because I saw it. The Puppet's music box. Off in the prize corner. It was like the entire world around me wiped away, like rain splattering against chalk on the sidewalk.

I had to leave. I cannot look at it. There's something in there more than the Puppet, and it frightens me.

I have to take a step back.

11/03/1987

Has it happened again?

(A missing persons' poster. Pictured is an 18-year old teenager with tanned skin.)

MISSING
SINCE NOVEMBER 1ST, 1987, ST. GEORGE, UTAH
NAME: Jason McLean
AGE:18
DESCRIPTION: 6'1, Short Brown Hair, Brown Eyes, 200 lbs.
CAR FOUND
Black 1987 2-Door Mustang GT
CONTACT (435)-555-2014

11/08/1987

I went back.
I present the following captures and my own notes from my portable camera's footage.

(A capture. 11/07/1987 3:23 AM. Peering through the side window of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. Inside is Kid's Cove. An animatronic, Funtime Foxy, lies on the ground; its pieces have been rearranged, and the mascot has been reduced to a mangle of parts.)

(Note: A window was left unlocked.)

(A capture, 11/07/1987 3:25 AM. The camera now focuses on Funtime Foxy's mascot head, which stares blankly at the floor and is illuminated by a flashlight. A secondary head attached to the endoskeleton's shoulder lays limp. Unbeknownst to the camera's holder, the secondary head's eyes stare at the camera.)

(Note: There is a possibility that this mascot was scanning me. I wore a mask. A constant and irritating static was coming from the animatronic's mouth.)

(A capture, 3:27 AM. The camera's holder stands in front of the Show Stage. Toy Freddy, Toy Bonnie, and Toy Chica are defunct.)

(Note: There was a vaguely acrid smell coming from the Show Stage. I would presume the animatronics are not receiving regular maintenance.)

(3:30 AM. Staring down the length of a hallway. To the right are the bathrooms. At the far end of the hallway, a door labelled "PARTS AND SERVICE" and an opening to the left. A dark stain is splattered on the floor.)

(Note: I begin to move faster at this point.)

(3:31 AM. A human hand can be seen opening the "PARTS AND SERVICE" door. Inside are several spare endoskeleton parts. A withered and stained Freddy Fazbear animatronic lies in the middle of the room. There is a large gash in the fabric of its left thigh.)

(3:33 AM. The camera is pointed towards the building's Security Office, which is illuminated dimly by a faulty light. The doors to four Party Rooms lay on both sides of the hallway.)

(3:34 AM. The camera is now right in front of the Security Office's opening. There are hinges for doors, but the doors have been taken off. Two vents can be seen on the left and right sides of the room.)

(3:35 AM. The camera is now on the left side of the Office, facing the desk. The desk's chair is empty. There is a security camera terminal on the desk; on it is the camera for Kid's Cove. A desk fan is running.)

(3:36 AM. The camera now focuses on an opened desk drawer as a hand folds through papers.)

(Note: I do this for several minutes, and I set the camera on the floor. I have to know what's happening.)

(3:41 AM. The camera is set on the floor, aimed behind the man who held it. In the back of the Security Office, a shadow resembling Freddy Fazbear stands in the darkness.)

(3:42 AM. The shadow becomes more visible in the dark. It is a man wearing a golden-yellow Fredbear suit. In one hand, he wields a large kitchen knife.)

(Note: I didn't know I was being watched until I reviewed the footage at home. I swear I looked behind me as I left and saw nothing.)

(3:45 AM. The camera is aimed outside the window of Kid's Cove. The man holds several files and folders as he is climbing out of the window.)

I should be terrified. Deep down, perhaps I am. But right now, I feel like this was expected.

I am considering the possibility that the Puppet isn't what I should be afraid of.

FINDINGS

11/09/1987

(A form.)
EMPLOYEE LIST
Jonathon Calden (Manager, Specialist)
Shelby Waterson (Assistant Manager)
Barbara Chambers (Head Chef)
Robert West (Lead Line Cook)
Peoria Davidson (Line Cook)
Tyrone Jenson (Line Cook)
Markus Flechman (Technician)
Fritz Smith Sr. (Technician)
Dave Miller (Security Guard) ~~(Night)~~ (Day as of 11/8)
Jeremy Fitzgerald Sr. (Security Guard) (Night) (Joins 11/8)

(Note: Where was Dave Miller when I broke in?)

(A transcript of a recording, dated 10/24/87.)
"Hello, hello! This is a reminder to all our staff here that the older animatronic models in the Parts and Service room should not be tampered with. Uh, the only people here who should be messing with those ratty things are, well, myself and the technicians. Um... I know some of us have a lot of fond memories of those guys, but old machinery can be dangerous.
Especially the yellow one. Not Chica, the- uh... the other yellow one. D-don't mess with it."
(A sticky note is attached. In messy handwriting:)
Why are they keeping those things in the back room?

(Sheet of paper. In fine handwriting:)
To-do:
~~-Re-sort the pizza ingredients~~
-Get Fritz to clean up those weird stains (Soda?)
-Figure out where that smell is coming from
-Fix Funtime Foxy again (should dull the teeth too)
-What's up with those kids' drawings?
-Why are the old models moving around?
-Background check on Dave Miller
JC

(A child's drawing. Depicted is a golden-yellow Freddy Fazbear animatronic, sitting limp. A little girl sits by the animatronic and holds its hand. She is smiling.)

(A child's drawing. Depicted is the Puppet, rising from its music box with a smile. Written below:)
PUPPET IS MY FREND. SHE GIVES GIFTS
(The other side has only three words.)
SHE GIVES LIFE

(A note addressed to Jonathon Calden.)
Hello. I received your correspondence regarding the potential use of the experimental Mimic endoskeletons in the new Freddy Fazbear's Pizza establishment.
Unfortunately, I must decline your request. The Mimic line is too expensive and is currently in a crippled state thanks to the whole incident in 1985. Now the few endoskeletons we have that still work act erratically when powered on. It doesn't help that Edwin Murray's gone missing. Without the programmer of the code we have no clue how to alter the code itself.
Besides, you don't need any of this fancy experimental stuff anyway. You'll do just fine with the X2s. Have a good day, and remember to smile. You are the face of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza.
- Executive Grant Starling

INVESTIGATION

11/11/1987

(A newspaper clipping.)

LOCAL ST. GEORGE TEENS DISAPPEAR.

Two teenagers have been reported missing from their homes in St. George, having apparently left their home in the middle of the night. Eyewitnesses claim they were picked up in a black Mustang, purportedly belonging to Jason McLean, another missing person from New Harmony.

Two other teenagers also from New Harmony have been reported missing. Authorities wonder if the disappearances are related to the 1985 missing children incident at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. An investigation of the local Freddy's establishment in St. George appears inevitable.

List of victims:
- Jason McLean (18)
- Sydney Callahan (16)
- Maria Gomez (15)
- Ian Watersen (15)
- Theodore Harrell (15)

I recognize one of these names - Jason McLean. He was arrested alongside Michael and his friends in 1983, for manslaughter. Did "Dave Miller" know this?

I've asked around the St. George area. Two of these teens live here, but the other three lived in New Harmony. Jason McLean's mother spoke with me - she said Jason used to babysit Ian and Maria when they were younger. Apparently as they grew up, Jason would drive them around and get into trouble - small stuff, vandalizing abandoned buildings, whatever.

I cannot bring myself to go inside that building again. I am certain the killer is there. Dave Miller. He watched me when I broke in. He likely still watches during the day. I *know* this is him - the man who murdered my daughter.

But I cannot confront him.

I am a coward.

11/12/1987

I received a message from Jonathon Calden. Around 2 AM.

(Transcript of a voice message.)

"Hello, you've reached the answering machine of Henry Emily. I'm not at the phone right now. Leave a message, thanks."

(Beep.)

"Uh, hello? Hi. This is, uh, Jonathon Calden. I'm the manager of the Freddy Fazbear's Pizza in St. George, Utah. You may remember me, uh, I worked for you in 1983. Uh... anyway, I-I'm calling because I found your phone number in the books here and... um, as you may know, there's an investigation going on over here. Five teens went missing. Fazbear Entertainment denies any wrongdoing, of course! Uh, the authorities believe they went missing here. That they broke in, and... something happened to them. We're trying to look for a man, Dave Miller - he's a suspect, but he just... disappeared yesterday. Um, anyway, we're-we're kind of alone in the water here, I think the company is just... gonna lock the building down. I wanted to just, call and ask that if you have any information that you think could help us regarding the incidents a few years ago, or... anything like that, please call me back. Hey, we've even got a position open now! The day shift, huh? How does that sound?

Uh... nevermind, that's... that's a bit insensitive of me. Uh, anyway, have a good night."

Dave Miller has already disappeared. I am disgusted by the husk of the company I used to run. These people are no kinder than the man who murdered these children. They are greedy, rotten people. Calden won't be getting a call from me.

THE BITE OF '87

11/15/1987

> ***(Newspaper headline.)***
> *ROBOTS SCRAPPED!*
> *Freddy Fazbear's is Closing*

They found the bodies. They were under the Show Stage.

The five teenagers were all murdered. From what I read in the newspaper and the little information Clay allowed me, they were slaughtered all across the restaurant with some kind of engineer's tool.

I asked about the camera footage. He told me the footage from the week Dave Miller worked the night shift was scrubbed. Both relief and disappointment. My crime would remain secret. *"We watched the footage from the week after, but...."*

"But what?"

He told me he was already risking his reputation by telling me these things. I begged him. I needed to see what had been going on there. What had disturbed him so?

And he showed me.

Excerpts from the camera footage showed me the animatronics roaming the building. Walking at night. With purpose. The redesigned crew stepped right off the stage and wandered the building. Stared at each other, stared at the darkness.

The original models were roaming the building as well. They limped and stuttered in their movement but took purposeful steps around the building. Chica's arms stayed locked at her side like some kind of rigor mortis. Foxy would run into the hallway like a charging bull, only to be blinded by light and cast back into the dark. They were like predators... their daze was occasionally interrupted by fits of hunting, approaching the office, getting inside and bearing down on the poor guard until fleeing.

I could have sworn I saw the shadows of Freddy and Bonnie in the footage, even as they were walking on the other side of the building.

Clay didn't know what to make of it. Calden told him the animatronics roam at night to keep their servos from locking up, and that their sight system was recognizing the night guard as an endoskeleton that needed to be 'repaired'. "*Things like that. I'm no engineer, so I don't know if that's true or not."* I *am* an engineer, and I know for a fact *that is a lie.*

"They're attacking him," I said in shock.

"Well, looks like they won. Didn't you hear?"

> ***(A capture from the security cameras of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. A birthday party is being held in Party Room 3. Children are screaming and running from the room; parents carry them away or shield them. In the middle of the room, the mangled Funtime Foxy animatronic stands over a security guard. Blood stains the ground around them. Funtime Foxy's face is facing away from the camera; its mouth is clamped onto the security guard's head.)***

According to the newspaper and the police reports, Jeremy Fitzgerald Sr., the night guard that worked the week the investigation happened (and father of one of the Missing Children), has been grievously wounded. One of those *things* nearly killed him.

He's currently in a hospital in Cedar City. Reports say he's in a coma and unlikely to recover.

DISMANTLED

11/17/1987

(Newspaper clipping.)

FAZBEAR ENTERTAINMENT CUTS TIES WITH AFTON ROBOTICS.

The CEO of Fazbear Entertainment spoke in a press conference today, revealing that Fazbear Entertainment will be cutting ties with Afton Robotics following the near-fatal injury of a security guard in St. George by a defective animatronic.

Many are unsure how Fazbear Entertainment will remain afloat without its main supplier of animatronic technology. The closure of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza in St. George has struck a blow to the company, and stocks are tanking for both Fazbear Enterprises and Afton Robotics. The future for both companies is looking bleak.

The Toy robots have been dismantled, as well. Newspaper says they were "scrapped." Which means they've been demolished. Burned, then crushed, then disposed of. Good. I don't know what Afton Robotics did with the Endo-X2s, but I will not believe that the things I saw them do in that footage are natural.

The newspaper also says they're going to try again. Keep the withered, old models and rebuild. Those things... *moved.* They weren't capable of moving. I can justify the newer ones - William always did shoot for the sky when it came to the technology of the animatronics. But I *built those things with my bare hands.* They are not capable of the things I saw them do in Clay's office. Rudimentary movement, sure, especially Foxy. But this wasn't just movement. It was *thought.*

It was *life.*

What in God's name is wrong with them?

11/18/1987

(Torn-out page of a notebook.)

Another dream.

I stand on the show stage of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. It isn't the new one - it's the one I used to run. I look to my left, and I see Bonnie. I look to my right, and I see Chica. I'm not facing the hall. I'm facing Freddy Fazbear.

Bonnie and Chica seem perturbed. They move, like statues - turning to Freddy, then back at each other. As I stare ahead, I realize my vision is obscured. I am not me. I'm Fredbear. I'm inside the Fredbear suit, unmoving, staring at Freddy. Freddy's head moves erratically. I see someone inside the suit. Someone I know. Someone I care for.

I hear my nephew's voice call out for his brother. But I can't answer him. I fall, limp, onto the stage, falling off the stage, landing on the floor of the party room.

The Puppet slinks from inside its music box. It floats, like a ghost - levitating through the air, passing through it with ease, its limbs like tentacles. It approaches and I feel dread again. It stands above me. We are broken, it says. You can put us back together.

I don't know what it means. I sweat inside the suit. The Puppet's tendrils embrace me. Save us, it says. Save us.

I can't.

CHAPTER 5: FREDDY FAZBEAR'S PIZZA

02/08/1988

I return to these notes scarcely and briefly. As I drank myself into a stupor the day after I had that dream, I realized I am falling into a hole I soon won't be able to crawl out of. Something about these notes transfixes me, pulls me away from my life and surrounds me with the illusion that I can bring back my daughter. That, if I find this "Dave Miller", I can undo his crimes.

But I cannot. I'm done being a zombie and walking through life fixated on the past. I cannot heal my heart. But I can mend my future, and set myself back on the only track that can give my life meaning: helping others.

02/15/1988

I now have a normal job. I work at a local soup kitchen in Hurricane.

I won't abandon these notes. I feel there is something calling me to them, and perhaps it is for good reason. But I will only visit them occasionally.

And no more breaking and entering.

Probably.

02/20/1988

William and I don't talk much anymore. He's been very busy at Afton Robotics. Apparently, he hasn't spoken much with his son, either.

I called him a while ago. We speak occasionally but I realize I haven't asked how he's been in a long time. He told me he's considering dropping out of college, which his mother isn't happy about. I told him he should think about what's best for himself, not his parents. I asked if he'd spoken with his father recently.

"No. He's always wrapped up in work. I get the feeling he doesn't care at all about me, or... what I'm going through."

I said I'm sure his father loves him very much, and is just stressed given what happened in St. George. *"He's lost a great deal as well, Michael."*

We all cope differently.

BACK IN HURRICANE

03/20/1988

True to their word, the Freddy's in Hurricane is reopening.

05/29/1988

My sister came to visit today. I do not write about her here, but Jen comes by every couple weeks - she drops off groceries, refuses payment, and tends to clean around the house. Every time I tell her she doesn't need to do this - that I can take care of myself. She never listens. Groceries, cleaning, talking, gone.

I suppose not *all* the light in my life has left.

08/11/1988

Sometimes I drive to Freddy's and watch during the day. It's a skeleton crew over there. A skeleton audience, too. I don't think it's even reached the average amount of people it'd have attracted five years ago.

10/31/1988

Five years now. I love you, Charlie.

02/07/1989

~~Why were the robots moving? Why were the robots moving? *Why were the robots moving?* The Puppet is trying to tell me something. That child drew it. "SHE GIVES GIFTS. SHE GIVES LIFE." It told me to save them. But I can't. They're dead.~~

~~I had the Security Puppet built to protect the children. To make sure what happened to William's son never happened again. Is it still protecting them?~~

Disregard. Having a rough night.

06/12/1989

I suspect more people are going missing. No doubt security guards at Freddy's.

I'm not so sure I believe "Dave Miller" is doing this anymore.

10/31/1989

Six years. I love you.

01/10/1990

New day. New decade. Afton Robotics is coming out with a computer system, there's that. Haven't talked to William in at least half a year now. I still visit with Michael every now and then. He dropped out of college - works at the grocery store down the street.

He still calls me "uncle."

WAITING

05/19/1990

I have been checking out books from the local library. Reading has done a great deal to help my conscience. A book caught my eye: *The Stone Tape Theory, Agony, and Other Unexplained Phenomena*. The author is listed as Phineas Taggart.

I felt drawn to the book. Some of it has admittedly bored me, but at times I read passages that feel like they speak to me personally. I have to wonder if the thing in my dreams has brought me to this book.

> ***(A passage from The Stone Tape Theory, Agony, and Other Unexplained Phenomena.)***
>
> *"The name "Stone Tape Theory" comes from a British horror film from 1972, but that only popularized these concepts. In 1837's "The Ninth Bridgewater Treatise," Charles Babbage theorized that spoken words could leave impressions in the air, even after they've become inaudible. In the late 1800s, Edmund Gurney and Eleonor Sidgwick theorized that objects, materials, or even entire buildings could retain records of past events and emotions, and that certain individuals could play these records back, like a tape recorder.*
>
> *I present the theory that the paranormal phenomena many attribute to ghost hauntings may actually be the result of emotions, words, or events imprinted into the environment around them."*

I picked this book on a whim, and at first found it to be the work of an insane person. Evidently, so did most readers, judging by the reviews I've read. But as I read, I began to think back on what I saw in Clay Burke's office, watching his computer monitor.

I thought back to the new Chica. How she tore her beak off of her face, like it was learned behavior, something she'd been doing for years. How Funtime Foxy had been taken apart and put back together wrong. And how easily the toys we sold in 1983 could be dismantled.

I thought of my Charlie, who would yell at the other children for stomping on bugs or hurting animals. She was a natural protector.

Just like...

07/21/1990

I returned the book and have not devoted much more thought to that particular line of discussion. I can't fall back into that hole. I'm getting *better.*

10/31/1990

Seven years. I love you.

10/31/1991

Eight years. I love you.

10/31/1992

Nine years. I love you.

04/12/1993

I'm surprised to hear William has moved away from his home, and has gifted it to Michael. I have to wonder if he's doing it to win back Michael's favor - I think William and I both know ever since the divorce Michael preferred spending time with his mother.

10/31/1993

It has been ten years since you left me. I feel I am slowly learning to move on... maybe. I cannot bring you back, and I cannot forget you. But I am trying my best to mend a life for myself without you - without them. My grief has controlled me ever since you died. I hope I can someday control it.

I *want* to get better.

I love you, Charlie.

11/01/1993

(Newspaper clipping.)

ANOTHER MISSING PERSON IN HURRICANE

In what is the latest in a string of disappearances in Hurricane UT, local citizen Jonathon Calden has been reported missing.

Calden was last seen leaving his apartment around 10 PM on the 29th of October. Neighbors report that he has a job as a security guard for the night shift at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, which has dwindled in popularity thanks to local rumors surrounding the missing children incident of 1985. Locals are spreading rumors that Calden was murdered.

Police are looking for any information on Calden's whereabouts.

I can't say I'm surprised. Or that I'm heartbroken.

FIVE NIGHTS AT FREDDY'S

11/04/1993

Michael called me today. The grocery store fired him, and he told me he's thinking of applying at Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. I was horrified. I pleaded with him not to go.

I told him that place is wrong. He said he has to make money somehow.

I told him people still die there. He said he can take care of himself.

I told him the animatronics move at night. He said he knows his way around faulty tech.

11/07/1993

He starts tomorrow night.

Please don't die. You can't die. I can't handle losing more of my family.

11/13/1993

Thank God, he's alive. He told me he needs to see me.

11/15/1993

(Audio transcript.)

H: "Michael! It's so good to see you. Please, c-come in. Let me make some tea."

M: "Actually, do you have water? Just water, please."

H: "Of course. Give me just a moment."

M: "Hey, what's with the recorder?"

H (distant): "It's, um... for my notes. Please don't touch it."

M: "Okay..."

(Eight minutes pass.)

H: "They were moving."

M: "It was a hell of a lot more than just that. It was... I can't even describe it."

(Light crying.)

H: "You're... you're safe now, Michael. I'm here."

M (between sobs): "They weren't right. This isn't... it's not malfunctioning... the phone guy told me it was just faulty tech, like, their servos or whatever. And it's not! This isn't, like, a TV going nuts because the antenna's broken! They were moving. They were- they were talking... or trying to, I guess."

H: "Talking?"

M: "It wasn't their voices. They... they were making these noises. Like people. Human people. On my fifth night I swear to God they spoke to me on the phone."

H: "Why didn't you tell me this? You didn't have to come back!"

M: "I know! But I felt like- like something there was calling to me. In my dreams, there was..."

H: "There was what?"

(Silence.)

M: "I... Uncle, I... I looked inside of them. I came in early last night, to-to see inside them before the shift started and try to... repair them, I guess..."

(Sniffling.)

M: "There's nothing to repair. I checked the chips. I checked their servos. I even tweaked their performance routines. There's nothing wrong with the technology."

H (whispering): "Then why are they..."

M: "I... I don't... I don't believe in ghosts. Or... monsters, or anything like that. But I swear, I... I could hear children in that building. Coming from the animatronics."

(Sobbing.)

M: "I could hear my brother."

ARGUMENT

11/18/1993

I visited William today. I marched into his office, pushed past the secretary. He looked incredulous - asked me what I was doing here. I asked him if Afton Robotics had done any modifications to the Endo-X models in Hurricane. He said no.

"Then someone else has," I said. *"Have you talked to your son at all recently?"*

He said no. I told him what Michael had seen. William brushed it all off. *"Those ratty things barely work as-is. No wonder they're malfunctioning. Fazbear's animatronics have been on the downturn ever since we stopped making them."* I told him that doesn't make sense - those robots weren't moving or acting naturally.

I told him Michael was convinced the place was haunted. William laughed. He told me Michael has an overactive imagination like his little brother did. This was when I raised my voice. *"Michael is an adult, not a toddler. He confided in me and I believe what he said. Something terrible is happening there."*

William raised his voice back at me. He accused me of trying to be Michael's father. Told me I was trying to take away the only child he had left, just like his wife had. Our argument turned into yelling. I told him the man needed *a* father and if he wouldn't act like one, then I might as well.

That's when William punched me. I'm nursing a bruise on my cheek. He cursed and told me not to step foot in his office again.

I fear I have irreparably ruined my relationship with William. Why did I *say* that? The man gave Michael an entire house only half a year ago. But I cannot help feeling that this was inevitable as well.

I am torn between living my life and investigating. I want to find some meaning in life beyond what I've lost. Is this my meaning?

> ***(Newspaper clipping.)***
>
> *LOCAL PIZZERIA SAID TO CLOSE BY YEAR'S END.*
>
> *After a long struggle to stay in business following the tragedy that took place there many years ago, Freddy Fazbear's Pizza has announced that it will close by year's end.*
>
> *Despite Fazbear Entertainment's other locations across the Midwest, stocks are steadily sinking for the company. The company has been on a year-long search for a buyer, but potential franchisees seem unwilling to be associated with them.*
>
> *"In the hearts of children, these characters will live on," says CEO Franklin Scott.*

11/20/1993

Michael's closed himself off. He barely talks to me or anyone else. I am worried about him, but I'm just as worried about Freddy's.

If their closure is anything like it was in 1983, they'll just abandon the place. And leave those monsters inside. Keep throwing people at them. More disappearances. More deaths.

I still believe the additional disappearances of Andrew and Elizabeth in 1983 and 1985 were likely committed by the murderer in the mascot suit, as was the murders of the teenagers in 1987. The night guards, though - I do not believe their deaths were at the hands of a human anymore.

FALLING

11/25/1993

(Doodles drawn by Mike Schmidt on napkins.
The first depicts Chica Chicken, who is banging a kitchen pot onto a counter while smiling.
The second depicts a pitch-black room. The eyes of Freddy Fazbear illuminate the darkness.
The third depicts Freddy Fazbear, but without shading. Below it is written: "IT'S ME." Its jaws are covered in a dark liquid.)

12/13/1993

(A photograph of a now-abandoned Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. Written in Henry's handwriting: "I can't go back in there.")

12/30/1993

(A photograph of young children in Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. At the forefront of the photo, Henry and Charlotte Emily eat pizza at a table with a teenage Michael Afton and his younger brother. William and Elizabeth Afton sit at another table without food. Charlotte and the youngest Afton son are both smiling.
Written below, in aged handwriting: "05/13/1983 HAPPY BIRTHDAY CHARLIE!")

01/23/1994

I am trying to rebuild my life. I speak with Michael weekly. He and I seem to both agree that some things are best left forgotten. Michael's struggling without a job - I support him as best I can with the residuals checks.

In other news...

(A newspaper clipping.)
AFTON ROBOTICS ANNOUNCES NEW ENTERTAINMENT VENUE
CEO William Afton took the stand at a press release, announcing the opening of Circus Baby's Entertainment and Rental. Following the disaster that occurred on the first day of operation at Circus Baby's Pizza World, the establishment is Afton Robotics' new, futuristic foray into the entertainment business.

(A transcript from HUTV News Broadcast - Afton Robotics Exclusive Tour and Announcement.)
William Afton: "Behind me you can see the main stage of the Funtime Auditorium. I wanted to show you all this room in particular, because I feel it perfectly encapsulates what Circus Baby's Entertainment and Rental is all about. Rather than force costly ventures on our consumers, why not bring Circus Baby and her friends to you? These state-of-the-art Funtime models, revamped and improved for the age of tomorrow, can be rented out for whatever events you choose."
William Afton: "We can even host your events right here in the Funtime Auditorium, or next door's Ballora Gallery. We weren't quite ready to introduce these animatronics a decade ago - but right now they're ready to sing, dance, teach, and act for your children. Are there any questions? Yes, you."
Journalist: "You said 'right now,' is that correct?"
William Afton: "Yes, you've heard me correctly. Circus Baby's Entertainment and Rental is open right now, or to be more precise, starting midnight tonight. Be ready to get out those checkbooks, friends - you'll need them."

10/31/1994

11 years. I love you. The thought has come to me that you may still be here with me, and I just can't see you.
If you are, I hope you are happy. Like I wish to be.

CHAPTER 6: AFTON ROBOTICS

05/07/1995

I don’t care to insult the character of my greatest friend, even if he may not consider me as much anymore - that being said, I feel that Circus Baby’s Entertainment and Rental is a vanity project, not a sincere creative venture.

They’re based in New Harmony. I always felt conflicted about William’s creations - the Funtimes.

THE FUTURE, TODAY

05/08/1995

There are four Funtimes: Circus Baby, Funtime Freddy, Ballora, and Funtime Foxy. The animatronics were originally announced during a press conference in 1983 - these were William's first venture into roboticism without my involvement.

He did not exclude me for any reason other than a wish to prove himself. And, from an engineering standpoint - he did.

(Blueprint for an animatronic titled "BA-424-01-P." The blueprint notes highly advanced balance actuators in the legs, torso, and arms. The model is capable of performing synchronized, determined movement, such as spins and bows, at the press of a button. The model has a music box synthesizer in its chest, allowing the operator to import pre-determined songs. The model itself resembles an adult, female ballerina - she is nicknamed "Ballora.")

The Funtimes are highly advanced, revolutionary animatronics. I once joked with William that they'd be better suited to take down fighter jets as opposed to entertainment robots. The movement and actions they were capable of were far more than anything I had created - they used an experimental endoskeleton system resembling human muscles. It made them more durable, but also exponentially more expensive.

(Excerpt of a legal document.)

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY AGREEMENT

PARTIES

This Intellectual Property Agreement (hereafter referred to as the "Agreement") is entered into on February 13th, 1983 (hereafter referred to as the "Effective Date"), by and between Fazbear Enterprises and Afton Robotics LLC (collectively referred to as the "Parties").

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The Parties hereby agree that Fazbear Enterprises grants Afton Robotics LLC the rights to all intellectual properties that result from the collaboration of individuals Henry Emily and William Afton. These intellectual properties include the names and likenesses of mascot characters from establishments opened and/or conceptualized by Fazbear Enterprises before the Effective Date. At time of writing, this includes all mascot characters from the following locations:

- Fredbear's Family Diner

- Freddy Fazbear's Pizza

The Parties hereby agree that Afton Robotics LLC retains the rights to any mascot characters purchased from the Party by Fazbear Enterprises.

William and I both agreed that it would be fair for us both to be able to use the characters we'd made in our business ventures. So that is why Freddy, Bonnie, and Foxy appear as Afton Robotics characters - and it's why Funtime Foxy appeared as a Freddy's character.

(Though I doubt that'll keep going on, not since the Bite.)

There are other characters I caught wind of, but I don't know much about them.

(Photograph of an unknown clown character from Circus Baby's Pizza World during the establishment's only testing day. The clown character is dressed like a tall, thin jester. Its face is pale and white, with a red clown nose and a green-and-yellow birthday hat.)

To this day I'm not quite sure how William got the funds to build these characters. They would've required more money than both of our companies had *combined* - surely he received funding from a third party. It's the only way I can understand these robots being made.

Circus Baby's Entertainment and Rental rents out shows to families. They either send off the Funtimes to homes or venues, or they rent out rooms in the facility to them. They don't allow photography inside, so my image of what it looks like in that facility is outdated.

I've read reviews for the establishment in the newspaper. Circus Baby's is very, *very* popular with animatronic and tech enthusiasts. (Why am I still subscribed to *Screws, Bolts, and Hairpins?*) I suspect many of the audiences that rent out the animatronics just wish to ogle them. They are, after all, state-of-the-art.

But reviews from families and other venues are more divisive. Some found the animatronics to be scary and almost aggressive at times. One of them makes the dubious claim that Funtime Freddy was recording her child's voice and repeating it back to her. I would imagine they're prone to malfunctions, but that hardly seems like something that can happen accidentally.

I suppose my (subjective) problem with these animatronics is that they aren't animal mascots - William wears the fact that they are machines on his sleeve. Fine for him, but to me the machinery was not the point. It was merely a tool to make fantasy and fun come to life.

DISAPPEARANCE

10/31/1995

12 years. I love you. You are always in my heart.

10/31/1996

13 years. I love you.

10/31/1997

14 years. I love you.

06/30/1998

William is gone.

> ***(A newspaper headline.)***
> *WILLIAM AFTON DISAPPEARS*
> *Beloved local entrepreneur William Afton has disappeared from his home. He was reported missing June 26th, 1998, in New Harmony. An Afton Robotics executive filed a missing person's report after Afton failed to report to his company for a week. Authorities are unsure if Afton was kidnapped or murdered, or if he merely skipped town.*

I feel torn apart. William and I may not have spoken in years, but I still feel kinship with him. Could this be the work of the same man who took his daughter? Who took mine?

I called Michael. I wanted to give support, but he was quiet and didn't want to discuss it. He's never had a great relationship with William, but I would have assumed he'd felt something for his father's disappearance... I feel perhaps his silence is out of ambivalence.

I don't blame him. I didn't have a great relationship with *my* father, either - he served the perfect blueprint for how not to be a dad.

Then again, perhaps I shouldn't judge. I haven't seen Samuel in years.

10/31/1998

15 years. I love you.

06/26/1999

Every day my grief hangs around my neck like a ton of bricks. I feel dragged further and further to the ground, and someday I will collapse. I grieve not just for my daughter, but for my greatest friend. For my wife, and my son. For what my life could have been.

I realize I have not dreamed of my daughter once since she died. I have her face memorized, burned into the back of my eyelids, and I think of her often. But in my dreams, she is truly gone.

I dread sleep now.

10/31/1999

16 years. I will never forget you. I love you.

10/31/2000

Another new decade. How time flies... it's the 21st century. Am I still the same man I was when this all started?

17 years. I love you.

04/22/2001

William was pronounced dead today. The police have given up their search. If you are truly dead, William... are you still here? Why do you not appear in my dreams, just like my daughter?

10/31/2001

18 years. I love you.

10/31/2002

19 years. I love you.

02/04/2003

"IT'S ME." "IT'S ME." "IT'S ME."

Always written. I saw it in the children's drawings. Michael wrote it when he was drawing the animatronics. He said he heard it in his dreams.

"It's me." It's who? Charlie? One of the missing children? Or...

...Michael said he'd heard his brother's voice in that restaurant. But that doesn't make any sense, does it?

Nothing makes sense anymore.

A PLACE FOR HIM

06/27/2003

I broke into Freddy's again last night. The one here. The one where it happened.

I didn't want to go in there, but like before, I felt called. I expected to see the mascots, but... they were destroyed. All I found were their suit pieces, laying around with their endoskeletons nowhere to be seen.

Something worse was in that building - something that found me.

(A photograph of Henry's left arm. Claw marks bruise his forearm. The bruising is blackened - it is as if his veins have been injected with oil. His veins are black and sickly. The dark substance reaches up to his fingers.)

It touched me - grabbed onto my arm as I ran across the restaurant. Had I not had the reflexes to strike it with my bag, it would've done worse. My arm is in excruciating pain - I feel searing agony where the thing touched me, something painkillers can't fix.

I was only able to grab a few things from the desk in the Security Office before I escaped.

06/29/2003

(Handwriting on a blank piece of paper.)

L.M. - two weeks; quit
J.F. - three days; quit
W.T. - one month; transferred to MO
P.A. - one week; fired
E.C. - two months; found in parts and service; disposed
H.K. - three weeks; quit
J.C. - three months; found in parts and service; disposed
M.S. - one week; fired

"Disposed." You scumbags.

(Hurried and distressed handwriting on a blank piece of paper; the handwriting is Jonathon Calden's.)
Freddy - Likes the dark. Knows when I'm watching him. DON'T LET THE POWER GO OUT
Bonnie - Likes the left door. Hangs out in the utility closet.
Chica - Likes the right door. Keeps trashing the kitchen - broke the camera
Foxy - Moves fast. Really twitchy, doesn't like the cameras

Why do they stick to this routine?

07/02/2003

(A blurry, unfocused photograph of what appears to be a withered mascot suit in the darkness of Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. It is the original Springbonnie suit used in the 1985 incident. Its yellow fur is lightly splattered with blood. A corpse is visible inside the suit.)

Nightmares are becoming a regular occurrence now. I'm also beginning to lose days - I feel as if it was only yesterday since I saw this creature.

So I don't forget: I broke into the restaurant hoping to find evidence of the company's collusion with Dave Miller. I found the mascots, broken and without their endoskeletons. I saw the safe room, the false wall open for whatever reason. I saw the ballpit in the main room, the net and the plastic balls violently torn from where they should have been. And I saw... that thing... rising from inside the pit.

When it saw me it ran to me, crashing through the appliances and tables like they were nothing. It roared, and it sounded like a mix between a man and a monster. When it touched me I was close enough to see inside it for a quick second, and I saw a corpse. Someone died in there.

I ran away, and for some reason it wasn't to the window I got in through. Instead, I ran to the safe room. I noticed dried blood in the corner of the room. Arcade machines. Some spare endoskeletons. The thing cornered me in there. And it would have surely killed me.

If not for the Puppet.

I noticed it in the dark behind the creature. Its mask was covered in dust, and the thing "walked" like a... well, like a puppet. On strings. How could it do that? However it did, it sprang into the room. It crashed into the creature. It writhed in the ground, and I realized it was *holding the creature down.* I stumbled, then ran out of the safe room. By the time I got out, the thing had overpowered the Puppet - it threw it off and rose to its feet. In the shadows I could only barely catch the Puppet slinking into the darkness behind the ceiling tiles. I shook out of my paralysis when I met the eyes of the creature, and...

I sealed it inside. I closed the false wall. I left the restaurant with that thing banging on the walls.

Michael was right. That place does things to the mind. It makes you hear things - things that have no basis in reality.

I could have sworn I heard William in that suit.

08/01/2003

That was William. How was that William? *How was William in that suit?* I couldn't sleep last night thinking about it. That was my friend.

I recognized him. I recognized the jacket the corpse was wearing. A jacket I got him for Christmas only a year before Charlie died.

What in God's name happened to him?

11/01/2003

20 years now. I realized I forgot to write it down in the notes. My arm is healing, but very, very slowly. I'm beginning to lose track of days and weeks. It's like my life has become this... haze.

Michael is fine. We talk scarcely and I struggle to remember the discussions.

A DREAM, PART 2

01/02/2004

(Torn-out page from a notebook.)

Another dream. The first in a while.

I'm back in the music box. It's torn and withered by years of rotting. This force is back, but it feels weaker. There's something wrong with it. I approach it.

The Puppet has also been touched by that thing. Like my arm, there's this... dark substance inside of it. It seems like it's in pain. I approach it. I am terrified of it, but I also cannot leave it to suffer.

I grab the fabric hand of the Puppet and hold it in my own. The white pinpricks of the Puppet's eyes look into mine as it shakes. I speak. I say it's okay. I say thank you for helping me. I tell it the same thing I used to tell my daughter.

Tomorrow is another day, I say.

The Puppet's shaking ceases. It lies trembling on the ground. Its tendrils lay limp. The pinpricks don't close; it isn't dead. Just sleeping. I stand, and I notice that there is a bit of brown hair flowing from behind the Puppet's mask. But I dare not take the mask off - I don't want to disturb it further.

For the first time in forever, my dream ends peacefully. I wake up in my bed, tears flowing from my eyes. But they aren't tears of sadness.

The agony in my arm has subsided. It's healing much faster, and I can feel my fingers again. I don't know what's happening, but I've come to fully and completely accept that what's happening in that pizzeria is something beyond my understanding. Something supernatural. I will find out what it is... in time.

02/30/2004

Memory's getting better too.

Michael doesn't reach out to me much anymore, which is fine. I check up on him when I can, even if he doesn't always know it. He lives by himself now, has a steady job. I'm proud of him.

10/31/2004

~~Is it you? Could it actually be you? Is that why it helped me fight off that creature? Is that why it keeps trying to contact me? Are~~ This is nonsense. Disregard.

21 years. I love you. I hope you're alright.

A PLACE FOR HER

04/12/2005

I received a note in my mailbox today.

(A handwritten note.)
Uncle,
I apologize for not having reached out to you these last few years. I appreciate you having been there for me all these years, when my father has not. I'm grateful for this.
I doubt you will see me again. I've led a trite and meaningless life for as long as I can remember. But I'm going to rectify this. And I ask that you stay out of it. It is my mission, and mine alone.
I want you to know that I believe you were a wonderful father. I would have been honored to be born in your home, and feel the love and care you gave to Charlie. But I was born into ***this*** *home... and it is broken.*
My father gave me this task shortly before he disappeared. I ignored it out of fear. But I'm not afraid anymore. I can't be scared to lose my life when my life has had no purpose for years. I will put Elizabeth back together. And I will atone for what I've done.
Thank you. I hope life goes well for you.
- Michael

(Teardrops stain Henry's notes.)

I wish my nephew well. I hope he finds peace, wherever he is going. I don't know what he means by putting his sister back together... but, given the things I've seen these past decades, I must presume he is being honest.

04/13/2005

I forgot to mention this - time has been turbulent recently. An investigation is underway at Circus Baby's Entertainment and Rental. Someone disappeared there last week. A family I overheard at the soup kitchen mentioned it. Rumors are saying someone got stuck in the vents at the facility.

It seems neither of our companies can function without us, William.

04/18/2005

(A newspaper clipping.)
BIZARRE MURDERS AT CIRCUS BABY'S
It appears that grisly incidents can't be shaken from Circus Baby's Entertainment and Rental. During the investigation for the disappearance of an employee in the facility, two employees were found forcefully hung from the ceiling in the facility, having apparently been battered and cut by an unknown sharp object before their murders. In addition, the location's titular animatronics have all disappeared, along with the destruction of several expensive machines in the building.

05/01/2005

(A missing person's poster. It depicts a Caucasian man with short, brown hair.)
HAVE YOU SEEN THIS MAN?
NAME: Mike Schmidt
AGE: 37
DESCRIPTION: 6'1, 160 lbs., Caucasian
LAST SEEN: Mill Lane, New Harmony, UT
PLEASE CONTACT: Washington Country Police Department
(435)-555-4999

I’m sick of watching my family and friends disappear. I’m going to get to the bottom of this. Even if it kills me. These people need me.

I want to move on... but I have a duty to William, Michael, those children, my daughter, to find out what happened.

PART 3: 2005-2023

CHAPTER 7: REALIZATION

07/22/2005

My investigation continues. I've taken the necessary steps, I feel, to keep ahold of my life while devoting my time to solving this.

I'm throwing away any presumptions of looking sane or reasonable in these notes. They are for my eyes only, and my life stopped being sane or reasonable decades ago. With this in mind, I accept the following:

Ghosts are real.

08/03/2005

I've returned to *The Stone Tape, Agony, and Other Unexplained Phenomena.* Its author makes very good points, which I will summarize here.

Taggart posits the theory that what "hauntings" are is in fact emotional energy - that the human body can espouse emotions and memories onto the world around them, and that the environments around them can replay these emotions and memories akin to a tape recorder.

I'm done milling around the most obvious conclusions. It is clear that the missing children are not gone. They're still here - they're in the robots. *My* robots, which means I have a responsibility to clean up this mess. And my daughter...

But how? How did they get there?

THEORY

08/15/2005

I aim to solve the following questions:
1) How did the Missing Children come to possess the animatronics?
2) How did William die inside of the Springbonnie suit?
3) Is my daughter among these lost souls?

The answer to the first has been standing in front of me. It's how the children's bodies were never found. *Dave Miller stuffed the children into the robots.* They died in there, and the company disposed of them days later to avoid the fallout that would happen if they were discovered. A question I have yet to answer: Why did he do this?

I also suspect that William was murdered by this man. And put into that suit, to turn into the... thing that attacked me. The thing that will remain in the safe room until I figure out how to undo what Dave Miller started.

The animatronics were dismantled (by William? Dave? Someone else?). Does this mean they're free? Are the children gone now? I can only hope so. But... Charlie.

I am not ready to go back into that restaurant. Not yet.

10/31/2005

22 years. I love you. It may take a while, but I'll figure this out, Charlie.

12/26/2005

I celebrated Christmas with Jen and her family yesterday. I know these notes are meant only for me, but... I've suspected for a while that maybe I'm not the only one seeing them. Have you been with me, writing with me, Charlie? Perhaps I should update you.

Your aunt has a wife now. She has for a year, actually. They're very happy together, and they've adopted two children. This is just one of many Christmases I've spent with her family, as I can rarely stand most other gatherings. Their children are sweet. They remind me of you.

It was... nice. Jen will never know the horrors I've seen, and I don't want her to.

02/13/2006

Charlie has begun to appear to me in my dreams. The Puppet is gone to me - but I see the face of my daughter.

She looks... different. Older. It's almost as if I am not seeing the Charlie I knew, but the Charlie there could've been... had she not been taken away from me. In my dreams, she smiles to me and tells me she loves me. She looks like her mother. And she looks like me.

05/09/2006

At night, if I listen closely, I can hear it. Banging on the walls of the safe room. Trudging around the room, like a predator marking its nest. Routinely - laying on the ground like a dead relic, only to spring up and bash at the walls. A caged monster flipping between dead and live. Somewhere stuck in the middle.

What happened to you, William?

PUTTING IT BLUNTLY

08/10/2006

Afton Robotics is filing for bankruptcy. I guess the Funtimes were so expensive, losing them was a fatal blow. I wonder what happened to them...?

10/31/2006

23 years. I love you.

01/24/2007

I spoke again to Clay Burke last night. I was stupid, and I was drunk, and I called him. I was angry. I was sad. From the moment he picked up I yelled at him. I asked him how he dared to accuse my friend of child murder all those years ago. How he could look a beloved father in the eye and accuse him of taking children's lives not even a month after his own had disappeared.

Clay didn't yell back. He didn't scream, and he didn't insult me. He told me I was clearly not in my right mind, and that I needed to rest - that I should hang up the phone. I told him I'd shove the phone up his...

...Well, I wasn't *kind,* is my point.

Today I woke up to an email. (Not normally my thing, but I still check it every now and then.)

(An email from "cburke@washingtoncounty.org" to "hemily80@hotmail.com.")

This is the last time I'm giving you anything confidential. Take it and savor it. I'm not throwing away my career for you.

You want to know why William Afton was my prime suspect?

1) Nobody in that restaurant knew those suits the way Afton did. The only other suspect is Jonathon Calden, except he was too small to fit in the suits properly without risking the springlocks going off. He didn't wear them, he just trained others on how to wear them. And you yourself told me Afton had "performed" on stage more times than you could count.

2) His alibi raised more questions than answers. He just so happened to give us convenient times he was at his factory that skirted the timespan we placed the children missing at. His employees seemed afraid when they corroborated his story, and conveniently the camera footage for the timeframe Afton claimed he was there had been scrubbed.

3) Guess what else was conveniently scrubbed when we investigated? The camera footage for the Afton home the day he said his daughter went missing. Or, at least, one of them - Afton had a couple houses across Washington County and the man wouldn't let us into any of them. His son also wouldn't talk to us about what life was like in that home, and we had probable cause to suspect neglect or abuse was going on.

4) We looked into his past. His childhood is filled with red flags for future serial killers. He was a bully in school, and when he wasn't a bully he was getting bullied by kids bigger than him. He'd made threats toward his teachers, other students, their parents. We even tracked down his estranged mother - she told us how her son had been caught torturing animals in the woods, burying them alive in shallow graves. He was a lunatic.

Henry, I firmly believe with my heart that William Afton murdered those children. And I'd go as far as to say if he murdered those kids he likely murdered those poor teens in 1987. And if he killed them, then what do you think happened to your daughter?

You want to avenge Charlie? Quit missing the forest for the trees. And keep your investigation to yourself. The rest of us have lives to get on with.

PS. Aruba? You really believe that man went to the beach? He was practically a vampire.

I'm offended by Clay's accusations. But...

I'm conflicted. I feel a loyalty to William. I do not ever want to fool myself into thinking he is this... murderer. But I've been ignorant. I've ignored the possibility in front of me because it was inconvenient to me. And even if William didn't commit murder, I've come to realize he most likely *has* committed negligence. I heard whispers of OSHA violations in the rental facility every month.

And, while I've struggled not to acknowledge it... he was in charge of Fredbear's the night she was murdered.

02/02/2007

Could he have done it? I feel wrong even considering this. Did William really do those things as a child...?

Am I terrible for considering these things of him? I only realize now how little I knew of his family situation. How little I knew about his wife before their divorce, how little I'd seen the inside of his home. I let William into my life to see everything I laid bare, but I now realize William did not let me into his. What was he hiding?

03/23/2007

I... have to find out. I have to see what William was hiding from me.

I have to go to New Harmony. I have to go to their home.

04/12/2007

I understand.

Damn you. Damn you to Hell.

GOLDEN WOUNDS

04/13/2007

(A series of captures from a video recording, dated 04/10/2007.)

(A capture, timed 11:49 PM. At night, the camera is focused on a large, abandoned suburban home. Other homes in the neighborhood can be seen in the distance. The home's lawn is overrun with tall grass and weeds. The front door is chained shut. A sign can be seen: "PRIVATE PROPERTY - AFTON ROBOTICS. DO NOT ENTER.")

(A capture, timed 11:51 PM. The camera is now in the house, aimed at the living room. Chains are strewn in front of Henry, bolt cutters lying on the floor.)

(A capture, timed 11:53 PM. The camera focuses on a young child's room. Plushies of Freddy, Bonnie, Chica, and Foxy are seen in the corner. Foxy's head is torn off. The room is caked in dust.)

(A capture, timed 12:00 AM. The camera is on the stairs, pointed upward. Family photos can be seen on the right side on the wall.)

(A capture, timed 12:05 AM. The camera points at a room titled "STUDY.")

I broke into the house. I searched the rooms. I searched William's study. I wasn't the only person here searching - when I got in, papers were thrown around the room and most of the desk drawers were pulled open. If I had to guess, Michael's work before he disappeared - perhaps he needed to know as well. He lived here for a fairly long time before then, after all. William has a flaw: he loved to keep copies of everything he wrote. Everything he kept. Blueprints.

(Several blueprints for the main four Funtime animatronics. They are labelled with suspicious "features", such as "Voice Mimic / Luring", "Deter & Misdirect", and "Parental Voice Sync & Replay.")

Is this what that parent was talking about, with Funtime Freddy "malfunctioning?" There is no reasonable point in features like this unless William planned to do something sinister with them.

(A blueprint for a large machine. It is labelled as having multiple parts: "Excavating Arm", "Remnant Injector", "Arm Base and Balance", and "Remnant Reservoir." The blueprint notes that the machine can store a substance known as "Remnant" in a malleable state as long as it's at a sustained, heated temperature, and that overheating may nullify the effects permanently. It is labelled "SCALABLE CREATION OF ULTERIOR PRESENCE.")

This I couldn't understand. What is "Remnant"? Ulterior presence?
There were journals.

(A photograph of a stack of journals, ranging from the late 1960s to the late 1990s.)
(Excerpt from a journal from 1981.)
March 12, 1981

The hate I feel for this man is indescribable. Something only superceded by my admiration. He is a genius... the only man I've met who can keep up with my own designs. He is an expert. He loves.

I hate him. I hate him wholly and completely. At night I dream of crushing his throat between my fingers. Of drinking the liquids that come from the wound. Drinking his soul. Drinking his memories. Becoming smarter, better, and stronger.

But they are only dreams. I am not a murderer. I dream of murdering him, but then I wake up, and I come into the restaurant, and I greet him with a smile, a handshake - recently, even a hug.

He makes me sick.

Dozens of entries like this, actually. William wrote obsessively. He must have written millions of words across these journals, and a significant amount of them were about *me.* About hating me. About loving me. About admiring me, and wanting me dead. They ranged from coherent to completely delusional.

I was there for an hour reading these. I felt sick. I felt horrified.

But here is what broke me.

(Excerpt from a journal from 1983.)

October 15th, 1983

I have never been able to feel what others feel. All I feel is hate. Towards the masses, those who do not deserve the life they were gifted. Towards Henry, who has taken everything from life that I've spent mine dreaming about. Towards my family, whom I should love with all my heart, yet I feel nothing.

My youngest son has died. But I feel no sorrow. No regret. No pain. I feel humiliated. The hate within me boils. A volcano that will soon erupt. Why can I not muster the love that is expected of me? Why can I not replicate what came so easily for Henry? What is wrong with me?

If there is meaning to life, it is but an elusive dream to me. I have failed. I have failed as a friend, as I hold nothing but jealousy for the only man who cares for me. I have failed as a father, as I cannot love the children my wife gave birth to.

I have failed as a human - for there is nothing human inside me.

(Another excerpt.)

October 18th, 1983

Henry believes in God, this I know. But I know there is no "God." The love I see in this world is constructed, false - a façade men like Henry create to fool themselves. If there is an afterlife, it is barren and harsh. Dictated by the laws of mortality.

...But can I not twist those laws?

Every step he took has become a palpable reminder of his life. Every word he said hangs in the air, like a remnant of the boy. I come to realize one cannot die if there remains even a small piece of them. It is as I told him, in my feeble, weak attempt to comfort a son I cannot love - he is broken. But he can be put back together.

I must replicate this. I must create something with the power to live beyond life. And I will take this power as my own. This is the difference between Henry and myself. He believes in God - an almighty being, a grand overseer. But God is not a person - it is a state of being. Why be human when I can be God?

Henry's girl. He speaks of her often, and she once played with my youngest son. I see love and life in her eyes, no doubt Henry's own. It is incessant... but it can also be useful. Henry thinks he has the perfect life. But I will dismantle it.

And I will put together something extraordinary.

And then...

(A piece of paper with Afton's handwriting.)

Experiment Log 06/25/85

Hypothesis: Imprinting Remnant to a vessel; replicating CE.

Subjects: GW, JF, SC, FS

Control: CM

Dependent Variable: FF, BB, CC, FP

Experiment: Subjects placed inside suits during expiration. Control untouched after expiration.

Observations: Life observed within 72 hours. Remains removed by third party; irrelevant. Effects dulled during the day; far more active (and hostile) during the night. Subjects exhibit animalistic, simple intelligence; not as aware as CE. Control appears to be active, unrestrained by suit, manifests as apparition.

Conclusion: Success.

I rushed from the room. I threw up in the hallway. I cried. I wrecked his study. I cursed and raged. I collected more pages, as much as my bag could carry... and then I left.

A DREAM, PART 3

04/20/2007

It's so ironic - all this time I fantasized about finding my daughter's killer. Beating him until he's nothing but a pile of bruises and broken bones. I fantasized about seeing him locked up.

But I've had him locked up since 2003. Locked in that restaurant. Locked in the safe room. Good. He can stay there. And I don't just say this because my anger hasn't erased my fear of it - I say it because he doesn't deserve to feel the relief of death.

Neither do I. I am ashamed that it took me this long to realize what had happened.

08/26/2007

Jen is concerned. She says she's worried I'm slipping back into a depression.

Haven't I been in one this whole time? Only convincing myself I'm changing when I'm not? I'm still the same broken man I was when I started writing here. I'll never change.

10/31/2007

24 years. I love you, Charlie. I stopped him. I stopped the man who took you from me. Which... means it's over. Doesn't it?

I think I get it. The children are already free. He must have returned to that place for some twisted reason - to get his suit back? To destroy the machines he'd set on this path to begin with? But something happened. He wasn't killed - he put on the suit and the springlocks failed.

But he destroyed them. The endoskeletons, gone. By destroying them, he set them free - like the victims in 1987 when the company scrapped the machines.

So then... that's it. The Missing Children are free.

But not my Charlotte.

01/02/2008

(A torn-out page from a notebook.)

Another dream.

I return to the music box of the Puppet. My eyes fixate on the darkness in front of me. I see her.

My daughter. Charlie. Not a child. A teenager - an adult.

She steps out of the darkness. An ethereal figure. Glitching in and out of my vision, but yet perfectly clear. She looks exactly how I imagined she'd grow up to look. I call to her. I ask her how she's here. Why she looks so much older.

She tells me she doesn't understand a lot, but that she's still grown up. That my baby has been watching me, and growing up, and changing... just not in my world. I cry. I look at the eyes of my daughter. She's a specter of someone I'll never get to see - a hypothetical.

But I'm still here, dad, she says. I cry. She holds me. She says she loves me. She says that she thinks things had to be this way. I wonder if this was inevitable. And, had William not killed my daughter, what would have happened? Is there a world where she could have lived? If so, would I have been there to see it? Or would I have taken her place, leaving the remnant of a broken father behind?

But this is now, she says. This is the way things are. And you can't come find me. I still have a place here.

Why? I say. I want you free. I want you happy.

I hear a roar from beyond the music box. The gurgling, scratching roar of a monster. It tells us to let him out. It tells us he always comes back. My daughter says that's why she must stay - there is a monster still sealed away in this place, and she must keep watch. In case something happens.

I love you, dad, she says. I tell her I love her too. More than anything. She fades away from me, and I am left alone in the music box.

I don't have the courage to go back there and keep watch over that monster. But she does. What has she seen and felt all these years, trapped within the Puppet?

DEGRADATION

10/31/2008

25 years. I love you.

05/22/2009

I'm tired. Don't have much energy these days. I'm also old. 62 years, at time of writing. I feel three decades older. All I have the strength to do nowadays is wake up, work, eat, sleep. I don't "investigate" anymore.

I just walk. And wait.

10/31/2009

26 years. I love you.

10/31/2010

27 years. I love you.

I go to Freddy's every now and then. Just to check and make sure that the bunny hasn't left its burrow.

I went there to discover that it had been refurbished. The "Freddy Fazbear's Pizza" sign was gone, and replaced with a different sign: "Papa Bear's Pancake House."

I panicked at first. It was closed. I paced the building, and heard nothing. Has he finally passed? I can only hope. Or maybe he's just dormant. Waiting. And what of Charlie?

11/13/2010

I visited the location. It looks too different. So much was removed - the music box is gone. The show stage, torn from the flooring. The walls have been repainted.

And the safe room is... silent. Completely. I asked the manager. *"Why'd you choose this building, of all places? Don't you know what happened here?"*

"It was dirt cheap," said the man. *"Guess the company knew nobody'd be buying a murder restaurant for much more than a few thousand."*

I asked him if he checked the safe room. *"Man, I just want to sell pancakes. What even is a 'safe room?' Place has been quiet since I got here."* Like he had no idea what I was talking about.

When I was about to leave, I realized something had stayed the same. I asked: *"Why didn't you throw out the ballpit?"*

The man chuckled and stammered. *"Well, ballpits are fun. I dunno... I guess thinking about throwing it out gave me a bad feeling. Guess it belongs here."*

10/31/2011

28 years. I love you.

I think William is too weak now. He's trapped in that place, and can't even make much of an effort to escape. And he's being watched. The Puppet guards him, hidden in that building, away from the people buying food and blissfully unaware of its horrors.

Good. He can rot in that room. They'll never realize he's there.

10/31/2012

29 years. I love you.

10/31/2013

30 years. I love you. I'm sorry your father is a coward.

05/12/2014

Fazbear Enterprises just bought out Afton Robotics - or, what's left of it, at least. I'm living in a strange reality - one where this company consistently fails yet grows exponentially. There hasn't been a working restaurant in this area in more than a decade, yet their stocks are just growing. They're expanding elsewhere. I see commercials for a reboot of Freddy and Friends on Cartoon Network.

10/31/2014

31 years. I love you.

ULTERIOR PRESENCE

(Disheveled notes on a piece of paper. Henry's handwriting.)
WHAT IS REMNANT?
"Ulterior presence." Nullified at erratically high temperatures.
Why build it in Circus Baby's?
He wanted to "become God." How? Why?
Why destroy the endoskeletons?

(A newspaper clipping.)
AFTON ROBOTICS FILES FOR BANKRUPTCY
What used to be the leading pioneer in the field of animatronic entertainment has now become little more than a novelty. After the disappearance of William Afton in 1995, Afton Robotics stock has steadily been on the downturn since - and it's only tanked further after the murders of two technicians and the disappearance of several mascot characters in their facility.
Now overtaken in the field by competitors like Melody Way, Afton Robotics has little hope to continue, and has recently filed for bankruptcy.

(Photograph of a wrapped present. The label reads: "HAPPY BIRTHDAY DAD! FROM MICHAEL." The gift is unopened, and is covered in dust.)

(Photograph of a security badge for Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, 1987. The badge reads: "DAVE MILLER, SECURITY GUARD.")

(A photograph of William Afton's bookcase from his study. Below is a list of notable books.)
- More Than Human
- Strategies for Single Parenting
- Autobiography of a Yogi
- Parenting a Troubled Child
- Mascot Performance: Entertaining the Crowd
- The Stone Tape Theory, Agony, and Other Unexplained Phenomena

(A blueprint for a small device. It is labelled as including a speaker as well as a small light system, intended to be placed within a plushie. The speaker is a radio system; it is designed for someone to speak through from a distance. It is labelled "IMAGINARY FRIEND - PROTOTYPE 1982.")

(A blueprint for a strange-looking animatronic. It is a torn, nightmarish version of Bonnie. The endoskeleton is rudimentary and simple - the animatronic is not meant to be capable of moving, and rather is propped on a stand where it is transported externally. Only the arms and head are capable of autonomous movement. The blueprint is labelled "NIGHTMARE BONNIE - FALLFEST 1983.")

(A photo taken in 1983 of an attraction, called "NIGHT TERRORS." The attraction is set up to look like a house, with a line of people waiting to enter the front door. A sign for the house depicts a nightmarish version of Freddy Fazbear, and a disclaimer: "13+ ONLY.")

(A detailed drawing of a child - his head is crushed between the jaws of a Fredbear animatronic. Below him, a boy wearing a Foxy mask kneels.)

(An elaborate drawing of two dark shadows. They appear to be Fredbear and Springbonnie. The shadows are pitch-black, with gaping, white eyes. Below them, Afton's cursive writing: "My shadows.")

(A detailed drawing of the Springbonnie mascot. It is smiling, with innocent, benevolent eyes. It is labelled "W.A. 1969.")

(Excerpt from one of Afton's journals, 1982.)
November 26, 1982
I HATE YOU I HATE YOU I HATE YOU I HATE YOU I HATE YOU I HATE YOU PIECE OF FILTH YOU TRASH COMPLETE WORTHLESS SWINE HOW DARE YOU I HATE EVERY PIECE OF YOU YOUR SMILE YOUR MACHINES YOUR ***DRONING POINTLESS FAMILY***
WHY ARE YOU SO HAPPY???

CHAPTER 8: A KNOCK AT THE DOOR

12/12/2014

(A newspaper clipping.)

MORE DISAPPEARANCES IN WASHINGTON COUNTY

Locals are concerned by the disappearance of 28 year old Ken Jackson from his home in Springdale. Police investigation has determined that Jackson was forcefully removed from his home and kidnapped, and there was evidence of a brutal struggle within the home.

Since 2010, people have been slowly disappearing from towns in Washington County. A single mother was reported missing after her kids reported her to have fallen into a sewer grate in St. George. A construction worker disappeared from his post in Santa Clara only minutes after he was seen by his fellow workers.

What menace is skulking the county? Could it be connected to the disappearances of five children in 1985 that ravaged the community in Hurricane?

I don't understand. If William is trapped in that place, who is kidnapping people?

02/12/2015

I was cooking something at the soup kitchen today when I overheard two homeless men talking about something peculiar. When I served them I asked if I could sit with them and hear more about it. What I heard was... strange, to say the least.

They told me that they've been hearing something in the sewers at night where they sleep, under the overpass by SR-59. They said it sounded like grating metal, but also like a snake - like something slithering in the concrete.

And that it laughed. Not just any laugh, but "like one of those mascot robot things," in their words. That's peculiar. And not something I think would just be made up by crazy people.

07/02/2015

Papa Bear's Pancake House is no more. When I went back to what used to be Freddy's, the sign had been taken down. Now it's "Jeff's Pizza".

I went in, ordered a slice. It's better than what we served, I'll give them that. I asked the man at the cash register - Jeff, I assume - what had happened. He told me the last owner had some sort of mental breakdown a couple months ago - something about feeling claustrophobic in the building, feeling like something was watching him. *"Well, that and the pancakes sucked,"* he said. *"Didn't make a lotta money."*

As I left the building I noted that the ballpit was still there. A "DO NOT USE" sign was put on it. I asked what was with the ballpit. Jeff simply responded, *"Sure the guy left it there for a reason. I ain't superstitious, but I'd rather just let leave it alone."*

08/04/2015

Went to Springdale, asked around. Wasn't sure if I'd find something, but I did - I spoke to Ken Jackson's girlfriend, who told me she'd been hearing laughing and strange noises coming from what she presumed to be some kind of wild animal coming from their storm drain in the week leading up to his disappearance. She swore it was some kind of bear, but that it didn't make sense - why would a bear be in the sewers?

I think I know why.

10/31/2015

32 years. I love you. Are you content with the role you've chosen? I feel like I am obligated to take you from that place even if you don't want it. But you know more than I do at this point, Charlie.

THE WASHINGTON COUNTY CRYPTIDS

04/18/2016

Another disappearance in St. George. Older teenager, taken from his bedroom. It wrecked everything in his room, too. Authorities said it looked like a wild animal trashed the place. Everything was broken and crushed.

Everything except his pet rabbit, they said.

06/12/2016

Something else interesting. *This* I found on social media - some teenager from New Harmony made a post on it.

> ***(Printed screenshot from a social media website.)***
> *Craig Smythe - 8 hrs*
> *"saw something pretty screwed up at the junkyard on 25th lol. we thought it was some guy's art project or something but then it started moving. it glided around the junkyard like it was on roller skates or something, had this big lobster claw on it. it glided off into the trees and disappeared! we got a picture, kinda crazy"*
> ***(A photo is attached - it is blurry and unfocused, but a robot made of junk and scrap can be made out. On its right hand, a large serrated claw is seen. It has large pigtails and a skirt; its eyes glow green.)***
> *Comment by Ned Teller - 6 hrs*
> *"quit posting fake crap. if it were real you would've actually gotten a clear pic lmao"*
> *Comment by Craig Smythe - 6 hrs*
> *"oh yeah i'll just go up to the killer robot and take a selfie with it, idiot. don't you have women to disappoint?"*

Not cause for concern... yet. I don't recognize the claw, but those pigtails look like the Circus Baby prototype William showed me in '82.

10/31/2016

33 years. I love you.

03/21/2017

Another disappearance.

08/30/2017

> ***(Printed screenshot from a social media website.)***
> *Sandra Welker - 3 days*
> *"man i stg something creepy is in the sewers here. just caught my little sister talking to someone in the sewers like she's in that clown movie or something. i didn't see anything when i looked but she told me it was freddy fazbear. bruh wth is in the sewers thats got the voice of that dumb robot my dad liked when he was a kid"*
> *Comment by Dawn Carlisle - 3 days*
> *"we all float down here Sandra!!! come down to the sewers lol"*
> *Comment by Sandra Welker - 2 days*
> *"stop it LMAO that stuff freaks me out"*

This corroborates what I'm seeing from other reports. There's something down in the sewers, but what?

LEGION

10/31/2017

34 years. I love you. I wish I were strong enough to steal you from your prison. And free you.

01/24/2018

Another disappearance. I'm beginning to notice some patterns here.

There is something roaming Washington County. Whatever it is, it uses the sewer systems, and it likes to kidnap people. It doesn't hurt kids - it spares them, as well as animals. It targets older teens or adults. I don't know what it looks like, but I have a suspicion.

There is something else roaming Washington County, albeit slower, less active, and less subtle.

> ***(A newspaper clipping.)***
> *STRING OF ANIMAL MUTILATIONS BAFFLE AUTHORITIES*
> *The Red Cliffs National Conservation Area has been plagued by a series of connected incidents. Authorities have discovered several animals within the protected area mutilated by what appears to be serrated metal equipment. Gila monsters, desert tortoises, and chuckwallas have been found dismembered multiple times over the last year - some alive, some dead.*
> *Authorities are searching for the perpetrator of these heinous animal deaths.*

It seems to be focused on the Red Cliffs Desert Reserve right now - only a few minutes from St. George, where those teens saw the creature in the junkyard.

One of these is something roaming the sewers and talking in the voice of Freddy Fazbear. The other is a huge robot with pigtails and a skirt, killing animals at the edge of the Mojave Desert.

...I think I know where the Funtimes went. Or at least, two of them.

04/19/2018

> ***(A letter addressed to Henry Emily.)***
> *Henry Emily,*
> *We hope this letter finds you well. Though your leadership of Fazbear Enterprises only lasted a couple short years, your values and morals were instrumental in shaping the Fazbear Family. In recent years, Fazbear Enterprises has primarily focused its business efforts on television and interactive media. However, recent meetings have determined there is renewed interest in a Freddy Fazbear's Pizza installment in the area of Washington County.*
> *We have begun plans for an entertainment complex in the area, but these plans are in an early stage and aren't expected to reach fruition for many years. In the meantime, we hope to set up a string of Freddy's restaurants through a franchising strategy. Given your past experience with the company and with its flagship animatronic mascots, we are contacting you with the offer to manage Fazbear Entertainment's franchising in Utah at an incredible rate and with full creative control.*
> *We hope to receive a response. Have a good day.*
>
> *- Fazbear Enterprises CEO*
> *Franklin Scott*

Well, into the trash that goes.

07/28/2018

I think Circus Baby has moved on from animals to people.

> ***(A social media post.)***
> *Sarah Fleetner - 10 hrs*
> *"Friends, please pray for my baby. I left her out in the backyard for only ten minutes, and when I got out there, some... thing in the woods was trying to take her. I thought it was a woman at first because of its voice, but when I grabbed my daughter it reached out of the woods and it had a metal hand. It had green glowing eyes and it tried to attack us. We ran into the house and it tried to get in for a few minutes before it disappeared. I'm very scared, and the police didn't get there for an hour, and when they did they told me it was a bear attack. I don't know what that thing was, but it was no bear."*
> *Comment by Craig Smythe - 4 hrs*
> *"holy crap that's crazy. wish my mom were as cool as you fr. screw the cops"*

Should I do something? I'm too old now to run around the county like I'm a detective. I'm tired. But if something isn't done, more people could fall victim to these things William's left behind. I'm tired, and scared.

10/31/2018

35 years. I love you. I wish I could do more.

03/17/2019

Another disappearance.

10/31/2019

36 years. I love you.

06/12/2020

The Washington County Police Department put out a statement today - warned people to report any evidence of "animal or human" mutilations in the area. They say there's a bear on the loose.

I guess there *is* a bear on the loose, though it's not the kind they're thinking of.

08/20/2020

Jeff's Pizza closed recently. My last visit, I came back to see the building abandoned and empty. There is no sign now - from the outside it looks like a grey, featureless mass of concrete. If only others knew what lurked inside there.

I wonder if the ballpit is still in there.

10/31/2020

37 years. I love you.

05/14/2021

There's something that's been watching me recently. As I walk home from the soup kitchen I feel it. It's inexplicable, but I think whatever's been taking those people has set its eyes on me.

THE AMALGAMATION

10/31/2021

I saw it.

I can no longer write in these notes. My contributions are now delivered from a speech-to-text program on my computer.

I can no longer write because of the nerve damage to my hands.

It attacked me. The bear.

My updates will be slow.

(38 years. I love you, Charlie.)

11/04/2021

I see visions. I've been seeing them since I got out of the hospital. Slinking, writhing tentacles. Gnarled claws. A single piercing, yellow eye. It is the eye of my attacker.

My condition isn't good. As of my return from the hospital a few days ago, I am now bound to my wheelchair, and have lost control of my lower legs. I can no longer see out of my left eye. Considerable skin graft surgery had to be done to my face and arm. My face is now permanently disfigured. I can't eat solid foods, and I'm permanently stuck with a catheter.

They suggested someone to take care of me. I said no.

11/07/2021

Every inch of my body is burning. The painkillers don't work. I feel horrible. Agony courses through my veins like a poison.

I will tell you what happened, Charlie.

I walked home from the soup kitchen, late enough that it was dark outside. This was months ago. The 21st of February. I'd been feeling like something had been stalking me for over a week at that point.

I heard it. In the sewers. I walked past a sewer grate and heard a voice - it sounded like a child's. It sounded normal at first. *"Help me! I'm lost! I don't know where I am!"*

I stopped and looked to the sewer grate. This wasn't gradual. I knew within a second that it wasn't a real child. The voice repeated what it said. Help me. I'm lost. I don't know where I am. It repeated this many times, and every time it repeated this, it was in the same cadence, the same tone. Like a voice recording.

(Printed copy of Funtime Freddy's blueprint. "Voice Mimic / Luring" is circled in red.)

Instinct took over. I ran. As fast as my legs could take me. I sprinted down the sidewalk, and as I looked behind me I saw coils and wires sprouting from the sewer grate. I heard laughter.

I'm tired.

11/08/2021

It chased me into my home. It had hooked a claw into my arm just before I got inside, and I slammed the front door into its head. It squealed in pain and slinked outside.

Pain - *pain*... that creature felt pain but I saw no muscle or skin. It was made of wires, coils, metal tentacles and peering plastic eyeballs. Its face was made from ruined faceplates - Funtime Freddy's. How can a robot feel pain?

Blood poured from my arm. I locked the door and had begun wrapping my arm in a tourniquet, until I heard the thing crawling on the roof. It spoke.

"The party! The party! Won't you invite me in!?"

I realized it was going for one of the windows. I stumbled to the living room window, grabbed the curtains, and closed them just as I saw its rusted face peering from above. Surely it could've shattered the window, but instead it stared at the fabric. *"Hide and seek... I love games!"* it yelled, and retreated to the ceiling.

It played with me. Like I was a cornered rat. I scrambled to the kitchen to close the curtains there. I ran to the back door and pushed against it as the thing bashed on the wood. It was intelligent. And it tricked me.

11/09/2021

It was only when I heard the voice of a child coming from the upstairs bedroom that I realized the thing had tricked me. It had thrown its voice. Once I was upstairs, checking the window from my daughter's bedroom, I heard it break through the front door. It laughed. *"Now it's my turn to hide, and your turn to seek!"*

I was terrified. The house had become silent. I slowly walked downstairs, armed only with a flashlight and a baseball bat. As I walked I heard the thing taunt me, but I couldn't use the direction of its voice to help me. *"Adults aren't very good at games. They're very good at playing dead, though!"*

I walked downstairs. The front door had been broken into piles of broken wood. There weren't any footsteps. I searched the house. The living room, the kitchen, my bedroom.

I'd walked past my closet when I heard the whirring of a servo, and the writhing of wires. I turned and swung blindly. I heard a *crack* - I had smacked it in the head with the bat. It fell from the ceiling, onto the floor, and I ran. I heard a chorus of children screaming and sobbing behind me. It morphed into Funtime Freddy's voice. *"We hate adults! You're no fun!"*

It flew out of my room, slithered across the ceiling. It caught up to me in seconds. It reached down and grabbed my foot. I tripped. My head smacked right into the kitchen tile - my nose was broken. I crawled as the thing's grip closed around my leg. I felt something eviscerate my calf, and was horrified nearly to shock when I turned and saw the thing tearing into my leg - tearing flesh away from it.

It looked at me. *"Join us,"* it said. *"Be with us. There's room for one more."* It lurched above me.

REMNANT

11/10/2021

It swung a claw at my face as I writhed below it. Its claw only barely sliced my left eye open. I screamed and punched the thing. A plastic eye fell from the mass, and was swallowed back up by the coils. My hand was tangled in its wires - the wires wrapped around my hand and tensed. I felt my fingers break from the pressure.

My right hand was broken. My left was not. The thing grabbed my jaw and clenched its fist. I felt something crack in my jaw. My left hand dug further into the mass. I felt around for something, anything I could rip from the creature. My hands clenched around something. It was hot, solid metal.

When I grabbed it, something happened. My vision left me. My body felt ethereal. The thing's claws were gone. I stood somewhere else.

I stood in Freddy Fazbear's Pizza.

11/11/2021

It felt like a dream. It felt like a nightmare. I stood in Freddy's, but details were wrong. Like the place was a puzzle and it hadn't been put together quite right.

I stumbled through the main party room at Freddy's. I bumped into a child. I saw her face, and knew immediately that it was Susie Carter. The faces of the victims I had memorized in my head. She looked to me cluelessly. *"You don't look like you belong here,"* she said, and chased after a piece of paper flying through the room.

"I don't," I whispered to myself. I walked through the fog. They were all there. The children.

All five of them ran through the fog in the restaurant. Chasing after pieces of some kind of drawing - a drawing of them and Springbonnie.

I saw a child sitting alone. She had black hair and wore a yellow dress. I kneeled down to her. *"What's happening?"* I asked.

She looked up. She was crying. *"I wanted to look after them,"* she said. *"I wanted to be like Charlie. I wanted to bring us our happiest day. But they don't listen to me."*

"Charlie...?"

"She's gone now. She was helping us. She made us happy. But she left, and ever since my friends met that... that girl, they're going crazy."

"What girl?"

"She said her name was Elizabeth. She was a bully. She's gone now too, but I guess..."

The girl began to cry again. I stood up. I looked through the fog. "I'm going to fix this," I told her.

"Well, I guess you'll have all the time in the world. You won't die. Just like her brother."

And then I woke up. I was back in my living room. The creature stumbled back from me. Blood pooled around my body, and I could barely move. It clutched at its chest, where I'd grabbed it. It looked at me and laughed.

“You won’t die,” it said. *“I get my own now! Just like her!”* It shuddered and shook in front of me, and then it peered into my eyes. *“This means we’re best friends.”*

It stood up and slithered away, laughing. It was nearly an hour before the police came.

My neighbors heard a disturbance, they said.

11/12/2021

This leads to my current state. The doctors who performed surgery on me stressed to me that they had no clue how I was still alive. They said that I should have bled out. One doctor told me it was a miracle I was still alive.

I don’t think it’s a miracle.

I see visions every once and a while. When I close my eyes, it’s as if I’m seeing through someone else’s. Sometimes it’s glimpses of the sewers beneath Washington County. Sometimes it’s glimpses of someone else’s home.

I believe that I connected with that creature.

Is this what Remnant is?

YOU WON'T DIE

11/28/2021

I've made sense of the visions I see from the monster's point-of-view, but I was unsure of who this other person was, until I recalled what the girl in the dream said to me.

"You won't die. Just like her brother."

My suspicions led me to try and focus when I caught these glimpses. I saw someone disfigured. His hands were torn and misshapen. I saw him look in the mirror once and I saw someone I, at first, didn't recognize - a face that looked uncanny, like someone whose face had been torn off and reattached off-kilter. But then I saw his eyes, and I knew it was my nephew. Michael.

He's still alive...

I have to stop. The tears hurt.

12/02/2021

Michael was looking over a note recently. He seemed to be going through a lot, and ended up tearing the note apart. I focused and tried to remember as much as I could. Here is what I could transcribe.

> ***(Transcript of a handwritten note.)***
>
> *Son - it's me, William. Read this note carefully.*
>
> *I write this note out of necessity. You and I have more in common than you believe - we have both felt immeasurable* ***[indiscernible; sadness? grief?]****. You for your brother - I for my daughter.*
>
> *This is why I must tell you this, and I ask that you not repeat it* ***[indiscernible].*** *Your sister is not gone. I know you will believe me, ever since you went to that restaurant* ***[indiscernible]*** *the ghouls stalking its halls. You witnessed something incredible. You witnessed immortality, the extension of life.*
>
> *You witnessed the power of Remnant.*
>
> *Remnant will save those children. It has saved your sister. I began* ***[indiscernible; my research? my studies?]*** *with the intention of saving your brother. And, if you follow my instructions to the letter, this will be possible. I wish to help the victims of that horrible tragedy. I wish to put them back together. After I finish writing this,* ***[indiscernible]*** *into their den, and I will collect the vessels* ***[indiscernible]*** *I will bring them to my facility. And I will, in time, save them. But I need you.*
>
> *Elizabeth needs correction. She does not remember who she used to be - she is broken.* ***[indiscernible]*** *but know that I trust you, Michael. There is a machine in our facility - a machine that can manipulate Remnant. You need to use it. They won't recognize you at first, but they must realize eventually* ***[indiscernible]***
>
> *Put those children back together. Put your sister back together.*
>
> *And when you are done, come find me.*

He sent his son there. And they tore him apart. Used him to escape. William's madness knew no bounds. He offered his son as a sacrifice and they took it. And his daughter... Circus Baby... the robot with the claw. That's her. Did he kill his own daughter and put her there?

I'm done hiding. I'm done being scared. I need to stop this. I need to set them free. But how?

12/29/2021

What is "Freddy Fazbear's Pizza Place"?

CHAPTER 9: BEST LEFT FORGOTTEN

01/01/2022

> ***(A newspaper clipping.)***
> *NEW FREDDY'S LOCATION DRAWS BACKLASH*
> *Freddy Fazbear's Pizza Place was established only two short months ago, and it's already earned the ire of the Washington County community. Citing low-budget animatronics and low-quality cooking, the restaurant is already considered a disaster. Is there any way Fazbear Entertainment can re-establish its ground in this community?*

I only just noticed this. I guess while I was in the hospital they turned Fredbear's Family Diner into Freddy Fazbear's Pizza Place. I suppose they got anxious and decided to do it without my help.

Maybe I can use this.

02/03/2022

I responded to their letter.

They wouldn't be satisfied with all the money in the world. But I can still use them. Use them to formulate a plan.

Transcribing my voice for these notes is quite handy. If I had to type all this out, I'm convinced my fingers would've fallen off. Ha ha ha.

Oh, it catches laughter. That's fun.

02/10/2022

They called me back. I'll be going to a meeting with the CEO. Dinner at some fancy restaurant in St. George. I'll ask Jen to drive me.

02/20/2022

Franklin Scott is a detestable man. He has a smile wider than I've ever seen, but there's nothing but greed in his eyes. William would've loved him.

We discussed things. He told me I looked great. I rolled my eyes.

The crux of the meeting: Fazbear Enterprises wants to re-establish their presence in Washington County through a franchising brand. They have plans for some kind of entertainment complex but that it won't be up and running for a while. After I never responded, they decided to establish this location anyway, but it's been a disaster. *"We've been thinking of trying to make some things focusing on horror, actually,"* he said offhandedly. *"All the rumors about the restaurants make people's imaginations go wild. If you remember Afton's fun little attraction in New Harmony at Fallfest - something like that."*

I pretended I was interested. Told him I'd love to be in control of this brand, but that I wouldn't be able to make public appearances, due to my condition. He replied, *"That's fine. You can easily hire an interim franchisee to get their hands in the mud for you. We just want you to be the man on top here."*

"Why?"

"Call it a generational difference. New blood's being hired and many of the people here are at a loss as to what the current audience wants. I think

you'll know best how to manage the restaurant, like you did in the 80s. Nobody here is quite competent enough to take care of it."

I lined out what I wanted. Full creative control. No prying eyes. He said okay, and we shook hands. I asked who I'd be replacing - he told me, nervously, that this wasn't an issue.

"The, um, last franchiser had an accident."

"What kind of accident?"

"Same kind you had," he said. *"Bear attack. I guess he wasn't as lucky as you were. We found him... torn apart outside the building. Police won't do their jobs. If you ask me, they should have animal control searching every square inch of the county until they find it."*

"We're actually kind of lucky you answered when you did. He ran it like hell anyway. We had to sell off everything in it to cut costs, until we can get it up and running again."

I outwardly agreed with him. But I knew immediately what had happened. They won't need to worry about finding the culprit. I will bring it right to our doorstep.

END'S BEGINNING

06/11/2022

As of today building work is being done on Freddy Fazbear's Pizza Place. I told them that I'd need time to have the building up to my specifications. A large basement complex for "storage," and a living quarters for myself. I will live here for the brief time it's running. I don't yet know how to execute my plan, but I know how it will end: an inferno.

06/23/2022

No one can know of my plan. This is why I live here now, under the building. Not even Jen. I have designs I've drawn up. My hands are crippled, but I will make them nonetheless.

(A blueprint for a mechanical apparatus on wheels, capable of emitting a heat signature of 98.6 degrees. It connects to a central server, which controls the sounds it makes. It is called "R.A.S.C." - Remote Activated Simulated C.)

All of these designs must be greenlit by the company for me to get the funding for them. So the designs themselves must be vague. I cannot alert them to my plan.

I will design something that can lure these creatures around. Elizabeth seems to take after her father nowadays, and has been trying to abduct children. That creature, on the other hand, is friendly towards them. Both will be alerted by the call of a child. They will follow.

07/01/2022

My hands bleed daily as I use them to craft the RASC machines. Pain is no longer an excuse.

When the time is right, I have something else I must do as well. I must find my daughter. She wants to guard *him* from the outside world... but she no longer needs to play the role of the jailer. I will lure her to this place as well. And I will set her free.

10/02/2022

I've created several RASC units now. They are my sole company down here. I only leave my quarters to observe the space above. It looks empty. Waiting for someone. Waiting for my ward. Someone to do what I cannot.

The creature that attacked me has been trying to get in. It seems attracted to this place. Good. I've warned the construction workers only to be here during the day. As they always have, the souls prefer to walk at night.

I will keep its attention. When the time is right, I'll let it in.

10/14/2022

(Excerpt from a contract.)

<u>3.4 Salvage / Scrap Management.</u>

The Franchisee hereby agrees that all content outlined within Section 3 Paragraph 4 is to be classified and known only to the Franchisee and the Franchisor. The Franchisee agrees not to communicate information outlined within Section 3 Paragraph 4 to any parties outside of the Franchisee and the Franchisor, including but not limited to: friends, family, customers, employees, executives, FAZBEAR ENTERPRISES, FAZBEAR ENTERTAINMENT, FAZBEAR MEDIA, or other subsidiaries of FAZBEAR ENTERPRISES. The Franchisee is reminded of the importance of the non-disclosure agreement at the end of the contract.

The Franchisee acknowledges that the budgetary restrictions of the Franchised Location allow for and, in certain cases, require the salvage and usage of spare animatronic parts. The Franchisee hereby agrees that all animatronic mascots in the vicinity of the Franchised Location, regardless of nature, presence, or purpose, are to be collected and salvaged for parts.

The Franchisee acknowledges that the salvaging of animatronics is required under threat of termination of the contract. The Franchisee accepts the inherent risk of injury, maiming, and/or death that comes with operation of heavy machinery, and takes responsibility for any accidents that may occur in the Franchised Location as a result of salvaged animatronics.

The Franchisee agrees that in the event that a hostile animatronic is found inside the Franchised Location, it shall under no circumstances be engaged with after initial salvaging. The Franchisee agrees to do whatever is necessary to keep any hostile animatronics locked inside the basement complex below the Franchised Location.

The Franchisee agrees to fulfill the obligations of Section 3 Paragraph 4 to completion, and acknowledges that failure to fulfill these obligations will lead to immediate termination of the contract.

10/18/2022

I finished writing the contract recently. I wish not to become another corporate snake, someone who would sweep a death under the rug to suit his own needs. But this has to be done, and I don't have the mobility to do it myself.

Franklin Scott is confused as to why this is taking so long. It only takes a few months to craft a building from scratch, but it's been almost half a year just to build this complex below the restaurant. I tell him *"Quality entertainment takes time."* He isn't too concerned - he's focused on some other project, something about horror games. It's not my concern.

I'm lucky he's so sedentary - much of my funding has been going towards bribing the contractors and construction workers. *"Never speak of this again,"* I tell them. Then I hand them their retirement plan in a small bag.

10/31/2022

39 years. I love you.

11/28/2022

The labyrinth is functional. It spans a bit further than the main building itself. I've had it specialized for the RASCs' movement. My living quarters connect to the labyrinth through two doors, which I will keep sealed.

I'll need someone to distract them. The franchisee. I've had the building's security office installed in the middle of the labyrinth, accessible through a trap door in the main building. When the plan is executed, they'll have a way out. If they can hold off the creatures during the night shift - keep them from realizing what they're truly here for.

Now, to collect them.

ALL IN ONE PLACE

01/02/2023

I have finished another design.

(A blueprint for an animatronic, which uses Rockstar Freddy as a base. The animatronic is designed to output a "bracelet code, 93401233," and communicate this to a security receiver on "frequency FZ554." Its microphone, a "Dream Wand," can emit a steady lullaby. The suit is designed to seal something within it, then provide steady voltage to keep what it's contained inside.

The blueprint is titled "Lure Encapsulate Fuse Transport & Extract" - LEFTE.)

They asked me what this was for. I told them it's for security, and they didn't question further. When the time is right, I will send this to Freddy Fazbear's Pizza. And I will save my daughter.

03/12/2023

I imagine Jen has tried to call me several times now. Not that I've checked. I threw away my normal phone, and I only use the company phone for "business."

I've become a recluse, more now than I ever have been. Is this what happened to Michael? Reduced to what is essentially a corpse, undying?

There's been another disappearance as well. The clock is ticking.

In the meantime, a franchisee has shown up. Someone to "own" the building. For now, perfect, but I can tell he won't be able to fulfill his obligations. He can run the place so everything seems normal. By day, he can manage from home. By night, he can operate in the security office.

06/07/2023

(A file labelled "Facial Recognition File 0072." The file depicts the face of Molten Freddy. It lists three Security Tags as active - Funtime Freddy, Funtime Foxy, and Ballora. It lists Molten Freddy as Priority One, and reads:)

"With the most amount of Remnant collectively in its structure, this amalgamation of Afton's constructs is a necessary element of Paragraph 4."

I understand what Remnant is now. I've gone back and studied William's writings. To understand what he wanted. It's the soul. Remnant is the soul. That's why I saw the children when I touched that thing's core - they weren't set free. He didn't dismantle them - he repurposed them.

It's only now that I understand the depth of the depravity of this... creature. This monster that I unwillingly helped to create.

As if what he had already done wasn't enough, he found a new way to desecrate, to humiliate, to destroy. As if the *suffering* wasn't enough, the loss of innocence, the loss of everything to so many people... small souls trapped in prisons of my making, now set to new purpose and used in ways I never thought imaginable.

He lured them all back. Back to a familiar place. Back with familiar tricks. He brought them all together. Are they still... aware? I hope not. It keeps me awake at night. I could make myself... sleep. But not yet. Not until I undo what he has done and heal this wound.

A wound first inflicted on me. But then one that I let bleed out, to cause all of this.

He set some kind of trap. I don't know what it was, but he led them there *again*. He overpowered them *again*. And he robbed them of the only thing they had, *again*. I don't know how those tiny breaths of life came to inhabit those machines. But they will never find rest now. Not like this.

I have to call them all back. All of them.

Together in one place.

08/02/2023

Another dream.

I'm standing in a place I believe was once where the Puppet's music box was. But it's gone - I'm surrounded by tables and checkered floor tiles. I'm standing in what's left of Jeff's Pizza.

I'm not the decrepit, shambling thing I am in the waking world - I'm free of my injuries, and I can walk. The building feels weak. My Charlie is still in the building, but wherever she is, she is weak. The presence I once felt is diminished and replaced by something worse - a dark, indescribable feeling that only intensifies as I look to the stale, untouched ballpit in the corner of the room. I feel something terrible as I watch the ballpit, but my attention is stolen by a noise.

It's coming from the safe room. As I walk closer, I see that it's not coming from *within* the safe room - but from *outside* it.

I hear this... aggravating voice, from a younger man. *"I know we'll find something interesting here,"* he says. *"Rumor is nobody who ran the place even knew it was here."*

A girl stands behind him. She replies: *"We've already found a lot of trinkets here. Maybe we should just cut our losses."*

The man has a crowbar, and he's using it to break open the false wall of the safe room. I lunge at him to stop him, but I'm not actually there. He breaks open the wall. Stagnant air is let loose from the safe room. *"I'm sick of props and fake stuff, man. I want to find an animatronic. A real one."*

They step into the safe room and I scream for them to run. But I can't get inside - I'm grabbed by the long, fabric tentacle of the Puppet. She's in the ceiling, and she watches the entrance of the safe room. Watches me. *"I'm coming to save you,"* I tell her. She ignores me. There's something off about her.

I'm thrust away from my dream before I can tell her anything more.

08/03/2023

It's finished. LEFTE is a fully autonomous animatronic. I had to rush the completion as I don't believe Charlie will stay in that building for long. I've programmed it using leftovers from William's studies. It won't be able to operate outside the confines of Washington County, and I don't think it can quite roam the landscape like the others I have yet to corral. But it will have to do. She'll fight me, but she won't fight this.

In the meantime, Fazbear's Fright.

FAZBEAR'S FRIGHT

08/04/2023

(Newspaper clipping.)
FAZBEAR'S FRIGHT SET TO OPEN IN A WEEK
An experimental "haunted house" attraction is set to open in St. George next week, called "Fazbear's Fright." The attraction promises to be an authentic and terrifying look into the grisly rumors that pervaded Freddy Fazbear's Pizza and its related locations in the 80s and 90s. Rumors state that Fazbear Entertainment themselves are sponsoring the attraction, but proprietor Matthew Black insists the location is an independent venue operating via free use.

They're insane. Absolutely insane. They *freed him*. And even if they hadn't, this is in incredibly poor taste.

I'm enraged, and scared. I must find Charlie. I sent LEFTE out as soon as the sun went down. I control its movements from an RF transmitter in my terminal. I will send it to Freddy's, and it will find my daughter.

08/07/2023

She isn't there. She's fled the restaurant. I've triple checked the program, sent a dozen scan requests to the animatronic. *"SECURITY RECEIVER NOT FOUND,"* it reads. Where did she go?

08/08/2023

(Newspaper clipping.)
IT BURNS!
Fazbear's Fright burns to the ground!
A new local attraction based on an ancient pizzeria chain burned down overnight. Authorities have not ruled out foul play, but at the moment it seems to have been caused by faulty wiring. Very little was found at the scene. The few items that were salvaged will be sold at public auction.

At first I was thankful to hear it burned down. Until I read the obituaries, and saw that the guard they had watching the place at night had died in the fire. His name was Hudson Foster.

I have to get to that auction.

08/15/2023

I faced sunlight for the first time in nearly a year today. Ended up getting Jacob (the franchisee) to drive me there. As I do this, LEFTE is recharging back at the Pizza Place.

They were auctioning off several items of little importance to me - I had Jacob write down an inventory anyway.

(Handwritten list.)
Freddy Fazbear plush
Bonnie plush
Chica plush
Foxy plush
Springbonnie plush
Fredbear hat and bowtie
"Security Logbook"

Jacob asked me if I planned on acquiring any of this. I said no. I have no interest in trinkets, and the "Logbook" was little more than cheap merchandise for the horror attraction.

My attention piqued when the auction began, though, and one man outbid everyone. He wore a black hoodie and jeans. Kept his face shadowed from the audience. When he spoke, his voice seemed... wrong. Like someone I knew, but slurred, tired. Warped.

It was my nephew. It was Michael.

He bought everything from the auction. One man piped up and yelled that it wasn't fair for one man to buy out the entire catalogue, but the auctioneer was too busy counting money to care. Michael took everything and left wordlessly. He didn't see me, and I'm glad he didn't. I wouldn't want him to see me like this.

I presume he feels the same as I do. I still see through his eyes every now and then, but my recollection is fleeting. I miss you, Michael. I miss everyone.

When I approached the auctioneer I realized he was the same man from my dream, who opened the safe room. I asked him if anything else had been found in the ruins, and he replied in the negative. *"Huge shame. A lot of it was junk, but I was proud of what we found."*

"What you found?"

"The animatronic, dude. Authentic Springbonnie." He told me he was excited to eventually clean it, as it smelled awful. *"Couldn't find a trace of the endoskeleton. There were parts of the suit's shells around the place, but the endoskeleton just... poof, dude. Disappeared."*

I asked him if he found anything else. He said Hudson had mentioned something to him about a puppet character in the place, but he insisted Hudson must have been seeing things, because they'd only ever found one animatronic.

Perhaps this one found *them,* instead.

I said thanks for his time, and left. *"Man, you look gnarly. You could star in your own horror attraction if you wanted to!"*

08/20/2023

Every other night LEFTE is sent out to roam the county until sunrise. Every night I do not find her. Funnily enough, I am not scared that someone will see it.

For some reason I have a feeling that another machine skulking the dark won't surprise anyone. I just hope I can find her before it's too late.

08/22/2023

I cannot imagine what happened inside Fazbear's Fright in the short time that *he* was in there, but I have no doubt it burnt down because of him. That the guard died because of him. That place was filled with artifacts from those restaurants, places where over ten lives were taken.

The agony in that building must have been tremendous. It was doomed the moment it began.

PURPLE BLOOD

08/24/2023

It found her. LEFTE found her.

She was laying in a junkyard somewhere in the outskirts of Hurricane. I didn't even have to deliver the orders. It did it automatically. It lured her into the suit. Played the music. And trapped her inside. The voltage will keep her immobile, and the music playing inside will keep her docile.

I'm sorry, Charlie. But I have to be a father.

It will take a while to return. Its movement is hampered by what's inside. Once it's here, and I have the others here as well, I will bury this place and its monsters so deep that, hopefully, they won't even be memories.

08/25/2023

Jacob has died. He attempted to salvage an animatronic that appeared in the back alley. I was not surprised to see from the camera footage that it was Circus Baby, or what was left of her. She's become a creature beyond any recognition to what the original robot looked like.

Elizabeth killed him. The next morning, she was gone, and the salvaging room was empty aside from Jacob's remains.

I had the staff clean it up. Waved more money in front of their faces. *"Tell no one,"* I said. I am ashamed of what I've done, but if anyone learns of this, it will jeopardize the plan.

...

There is no justification for what I've done. I am no better than the rest of this company.

09/06/2023

I caught another glimpse. Another brief window of sight. This time from Michael.

He was looking at our ad in the paper - to replace what Jacob owned. Could he show up at my doorstep? I did not intend this job to be his. He has suffered so much.

But maybe fate has just drawn us to this. Maybe this is how it is meant to be.

Can he see through my eyes, like I've seen through his?

09/20/2023

Afton's amalgamation continues to scout out this building and try to find a way in. Evidently, Elizabeth is around, and watching. I have no doubt she'll find a way in as well.

And *him*.

I won't worry about William. I know he'll show up here. I've been done chasing after a killer for years now. My concern is to set his victims free. I know fate will come for him.

I've lost contact with LEFTE. It runs on a low power mode - I think it's malfunctioning. Charlie's interaction with it must be more volatile than I expected.

I can only have faith that I programmed it well enough to find a way back here. If it does, the cameras will see.

10/15/2023

He took the job. Michael applied. Not Mike Schmidt. Not a fake name.

He applied as "Michael Afton."

I was ashamed to let him see me. I had another staff conduct the interview in my place. I do not want him to see my face. I do not want him to see what's become of me. He will hear nothing of me but my instruction tapes and my final communication.

I am terrified for him. But he's made his choice, and he isn't the troubled teenager I remember him being. I...

...I trust you, Michael.

10/25/2023

He starts tomorrow.

10/27/2023

The amalgamation is now contained in the labyrinth. I hear it at night sometimes. Michael did his job. I suppose he's had experience.

I tried to speak to it. We are separated by a few inches of tempered glass, but it could see me through the door's window separating my living quarters and the labyrinth. I spoke the names of the children. *"Do you know those names?"* I asked.

"I don't wanna play the guessing game! Parties need better games than that!"

I smiled to it. Put on my best attempt at the voice I once used speaking to my daughter. *"What games do you like to play?"*

"Hide and seek," it replied. *"It's our favorite. The first time we played was so fun, fun, fun..."*

"You mean at my house?"

"No, silly. At the restaurant! We played with Bonnie! What fun! What fun! Until the guard came, at least..."

I tried to ask more, but it just laughed and spiraled into the darkness.

I've sealed my fate by allowing Michael to bring it into the labyrinth. The only way out of my living quarters is through the maze. This is fine. I designed it this way.

The only way I'll leave this building is if my ashes are swept from it.

THE BEAR AND THE BUNNY

10/28/2023

I came face-to-face with the Devil tonight.

I peered through the glass hoping to speak words of comfort to the souls trapped in the labyrinth. I saw, instead, the shadow of a different monster. One with the ears of a rabbit. It had been watching me.

(Transcript of an audio recording.)

H: ...It's you.

(William's voice is raspy, and I can routinely hear gurgling and strange noises as he talks. I'm not sure how it can be heard. His vocal cords should be dust by now.)

W: It's me.

(William chuckles.)

W: You don't seem surprised.

H: I'm not. I expected you.

W: How'd you find out, old friend? I'm curious.

H: Don't call me that. Whatever we are now, it isn't friends.

(A pause.)

H: I broke into your study, years ago. I wanted answers.

W: And your new look? We've both changed quite a bit, I see.

H: You can thank your victims for that. It attacked me, almost two years ago. It made me see things.

W: So you've been enlightened. Like I was.

H: Perhaps. How are you in control? The rest of them are...

W: Like animals, yes. I once was as well. The human mind, inferior and limited as it is, can't handle death. It fractures. But it can be put back together. The fire woke me up. An animal one second, the next…

(A pause.)

H: Why, William?

W: I'm not William anymore. I'm something more. More than William was.

(I yell.)

H: Why!?

(William leans closer to the glass. I can see that he has replaced several of the suit parts, presumably from the fire. He now wears suit pieces from an older Springbonnie prototype on the endoskeleton.)

W: Because I am not like you, Henry. You were weak. You had something I needed, and I took it.

H: She was my daughter. Your niece. She loved you.

W: She did love me. She loved plenty. And now I have loved.

(William gestures to the labyrinth behind him.)

W: What you saw was the fruits of my labor. My creation, my children.

H: It's an abomination. It's torturing itself and killing anything it comes across.

W: It is powerful! It is perfect... or, it will be, when I'm done with it.

H: What in God's name do you intend to do?

W: Well, first... I will deal with my son. He seems to have some sort of idea that he has a place in this. That he'll stop me. But I only needed him to put together his sister, and now that he's done that... he is useless.

(Pause. William coughs / gurgles, and I see some sort of dark liquid splatter onto the window.)

W: After that, I will leave this place with my creations and my daughter. I thank you kindly for bringing us back together. She always did take after her father, and I know she will be happy to assist me. And then...

(Pause.)

W: I will ascend.

(I chuckle. A nervous habit.)

H: You're insane. You always have been.

W: You would know more than anyone, Henry. I'm excited to see what this plan of yours is. I knew it wasn't what it seemed. You always did know how to put on a show.

H: I'm going to stop you. You won't leave this place.

W: You'll try, I'm sure. You might even succeed.

(William pauses, then coughs up more of the dark liquid.)

W: But I always come back.

After that, the thing on the other side of the glass slunk away, into the labyrinth.

I grieved for William. But he wasn’t real. The man I grieved for was an illusion. A façade. It wasn’t the real him. *This* is. He hasn’t changed. He’s just peeled away the mask.

In spite of all of this, I still cannot bring myself *not* to believe in some higher power. My mind is broken. My body is warped. But there is real, tangible love in this world - in me. My love for my daughter is not any weaker now than it was the day she was born. I believe there must be some kind of light at the end of this tunnel for us.

The man in that suit was jealous of me. Jealous of my life. Jealous of my happiness. How could I have shown him that the love he was so jealous of was all around him, and he just couldn’t see it?

10/29/2023

Three of the four are accounted for. Elizabeth’s found her way into the building. I was right to trust Michael.

The cameras alerted me, as well. LEFTE has finally found its way back to me. It’s out in the alley now. It stays immobile, twitching every now and then. It’s volatile... dangerous.

I hope Michael can manage it.

END COMMUNICATION

10/30/2023

All four of them are in the labyrinth now. Michael has succeeded. I cannot bring myself to stand by the glass and try to talk to my daughter. Surely she must not be happy. The voltage in the suit must be painful.

Ha ha ha. Tough love, right? She died too young for me to get to that part of fatherhood.

(The following page has burn marks on the edges of the pages.)

10/31/2023

These notes have been with me longer than almost any person I've known. I flip back through my notes, back to 2005, to 1993, to 1986... when I started this. It's a morose feeling. From these notes alone, one would only be able to glean a fraction of my life. My grief, my sorrow.

I want these notes to receive some of my love, for once, before they burn in the fire with me.

Jennifer Emily, you are the greatest sister one could ask for. You will never see these notes, and I left without offering a proper goodbye, but I want you to know that I admire and look up to you. I admire your family, your wife, your children, and the lovely life you've built for yourself. I wish none of this suffering upon you.

Grace Evans, we have been separated longer than we were married, but much of the dwindling light in my heart is from you. I'm sorry I could not be strong enough for both of us, and I hope you are happy.

Samuel Emily, I'm sorry that I couldn't be the father to you I should have been. I am glad you are nowhere near this wretched place and its troubles. I love you, son.

Michael Afton, I know that we have not spoken in years, and I expect I won't have the courage to talk to you much before the end arrives. If I could, I would want you to know that you are a brave man, and a kind soul. You have more than repented for what happened that horrible day, and I'm proud of you for what you've done to set these children free.

I suppose this has turned into a suicide note.

Michael is almost here. I hear the monsters chittering in the walls. Elizabeth speaks of fulfilling some kind of duty. The amalgamation laughs and asks when the party will start. LEFTE is silent, but I can hear the lullaby sometimes when all else is quiet.

William only laughs and watches. Laugh no more, "old friend."

Michael is here. It's time.

40 years, Charlie.

I love you.

EPILOGUE

From: brockedwards@fazbearenterprises.com

Subject: “Some inspiration for you.”

Our creative department has made something for you.

Much effort was put into creating an entertaining spin on the false rumors about Freddy Fazbear’s Pizza, its various sister locations, and the myths surrounding the serial killer William Afton. We particularly enjoyed adapting Henry Emily, the founder of Fazbear Enterprises - this fictionalized version of him is more relatable and charismatic, a sharp contrast to the reclusive man who had no correspondence with the company after 1983 and disappeared in the 2020s.

We remind you that this work of fiction is confidential and intended for your eyes only. Consider it a “lore bible” - use it for inspiration when writing the stories. Don’t just copy it. Change things up a bit. Do not respond to this email. In fact, delete it after you’ve downloaded the file.

Attached file: NOTES FROM AN INVESTIGATOR.pdf

(Mind the burn marks. The original notes had an accident in the writer’s room.)

Good luck on the game development, Snodgrass. We’ll be in touch.